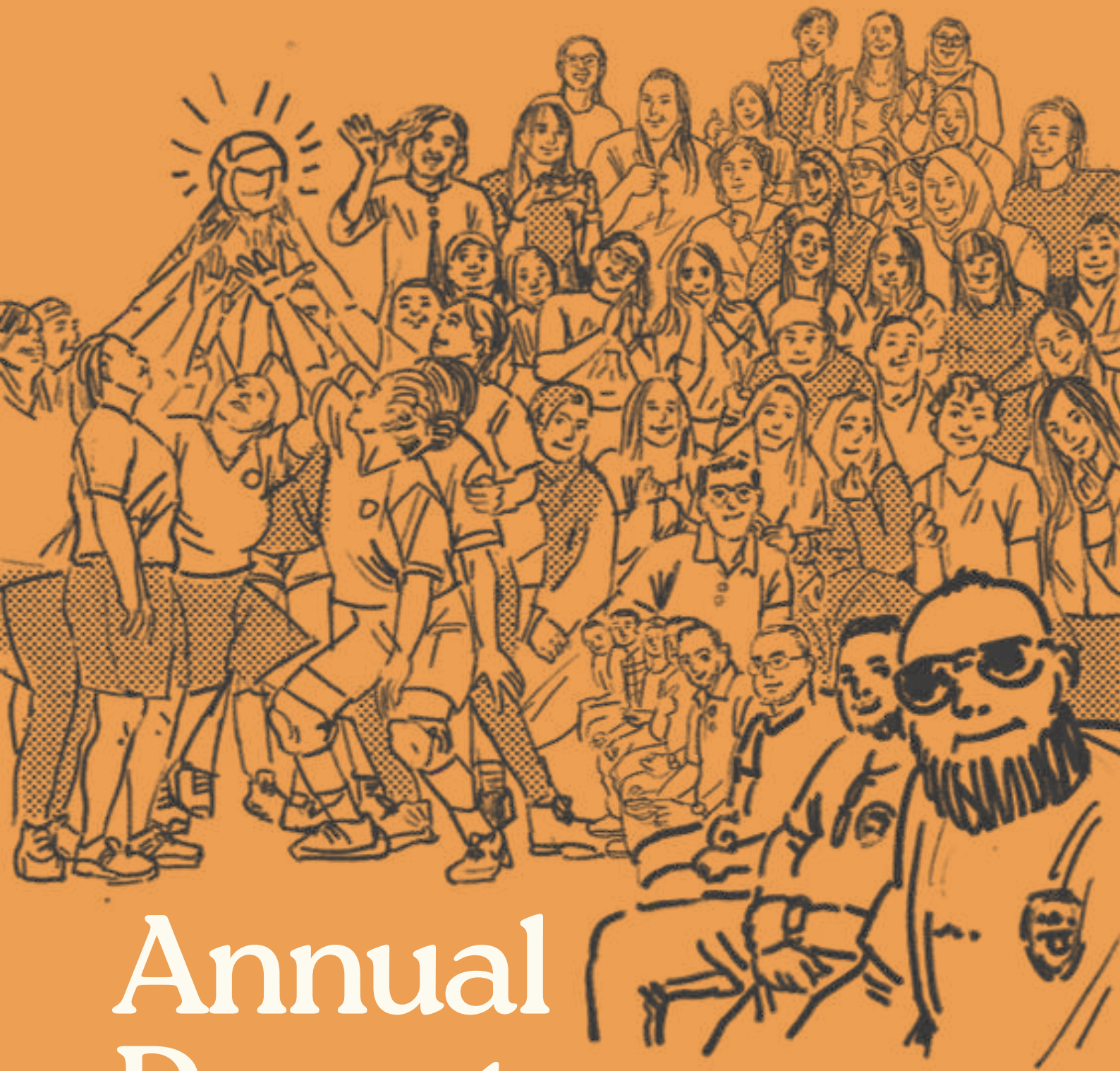
HOME



Annual Report

Humanitarian Organization
for Migration Economics

2025

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The Humanitarian Organization for Migration Economics (HOME) was founded in 2004 by the late Ms Bridget Tan.

HOME was registered as a society under the Societies Act on 6 Sep 2004.

In 2005, HOME was accepted as a member of the National Council of Social Service (NCSS) and registered as a charity under the Charities Act of Singapore.

HOME is a Tier-2 charity with Institution of a Public Character (IPC) status under the Charities Act 1994. HOME's IPC status was renewed by the Ministry of Social and Family Development (MSF) till 31 December 2026.

HOME has a Constitution as its governing instrument.

Unique Registration Number (UEN): T04SS0193H

Registered Address: 720 Geylang Road #02-01, Singapore 389631

Auditor: Helmi Talib LLP

Bank: Overseas-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited

Our Purpose

The Humanitarian Organization for Migration Economics (HOME) is dedicated to supporting and empowering migrant workers who experience abuse and exploitation. Three pillars guide us: Welfare, Empowerment and Advocacy.

We provide migrant workers with timely crisis intervention and sustained support through education and skills training programs. Furthermore, we actively champion the rights of migrant workers through advocacy campaigns and public education efforts.





Our Vision

A world where migrant workers can live and work with dignity and have equal access to fundamental rights.

Our Mission

We advance the welfare of migrant workers by providing shelter, critical casework, financial, legal, and medical support.

We empower migrant workers not only through skills training, but through peer-led programmes that foster leadership, solidarity, and community-driven change.

We partner multiple stakeholders, including corporations, government agencies, and community groups to advocate for inclusion, access to justice, and equality.



President's Foreword

Firsts



Even for an NGO so experienced at organising events, this has been a year of firsts.

In December, HOME Family's Kaugnay – a Filipino domestic worker community group – held their annual Trashion Show, where members paraded inventive and ornate costumes handcrafted from recycled materials. Except this time, the show took place in the grand setting of the National Gallery Singapore, bringing domestic workers' vibrant energy and creative talents into the heart of our historic Civic District.

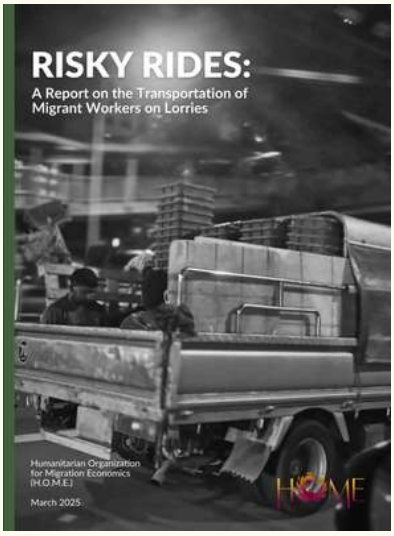
The winning costumes from the Trashion Show made a second appearance later at a fundraiser exhibition at the Objectifs Chapel Gallery. Conceptualised, designed and realised by Board members Ryan Chua and Grace Baey, the event transformed the chapel's intimate space into a contemplative showcase of costumes, photography and video, telling the stories of domestic workers in Singapore.



Changes

Following a review of our organisational priorities and structure, we welcomed Prashant Somosundram to take up the position of Deputy Executive Director. Formerly General Manager at The Projector, Prashant brings with him deep experience in management, communications and community building. With him on board, we have rejuvenated our social media engagement strategy. In *Kopi Sessions*, a new series on Instagram, Prashant and our Executive Director, Dr Stephanie Chok, draw our attention to hardships faced by migrant workers in Singapore and urge policy changes.

In March 2025, we published a research report on the transportation of migrant workers on lorries, calling for a ban of this unsafe practice that has taken too many lives. A year later, the government announced that ferrying workers on caged lorries will be banned from 2027. HOME has made clear that this gesture will not significantly reduce the risks of lorry transport, since only 1 to 2 per cent of lorries in Singapore are caged. We will continue to campaign for a complete ban of lorry transport for migrant workers.



Advocacy is one of HOME's core missions and new concerns are emerging. Over the past year, we have seen cases of migrant workers brought into Singapore under the promise of a particular job, only to find themselves deployed elsewhere, into work with severe conditions and below-subsistence pay. We will monitor this trend closely. Alongside the CritiCare Fund for Migrant Workers, we are also working on a set of recommendations to improve migrant workers' access to treatment for critical illnesses.

Renewal

Whether through events, services and programmes for migrant workers, or research and policy advocacy, the way ahead will demand invention, daring, attention and persistence. These are qualities HOME has in abundance, and which I have seen demonstrated often by everyone who makes this work possible.

This Board will complete its two-year term in June 2026. It has been a privilege to serve alongside fellow Board members whose wisdom and solidarity have steadied us in uncertain times. My deepest thanks go to every member of HOME's staff, whose dedication is the engine behind all that we do.

HOME's work is sustained, above all, by the generosity of our volunteers and supporters – people who believe, as we do, that every worker deserves dignity. We are fortunate to have you in our corner. Thank you.



Dr Ng Kok Hoe
President, HOME

Message from our Executive Director

Dear Friends of HOME,

Over the past year, it has become increasingly clear that the challenges faced by migrant workers in Singapore are not only persistent, they are evolving in scale and complexity.

Across our helpdesks, shelter, and helplines, we continue to see workers grappling with multiple, overlapping challenges — long working hours, abusive employer behaviour, crushing financial pressures (in large part due to indebtedness from recruitment fees), inadequate access to healthcare, and numerous barriers to seeking help. These patterns reflect deep structural inequities in the systems that govern migrant labour.

In particular, more migrant workers are approaching us after being deceived about the nature of their employment, arriving in Singapore to find themselves in roles with significantly different conditions and expectations. Some are placed into irregular work situations, yet face serious risks when seeking help, including the possibility of being penalised and debarred from working in Singapore. This creates a difficult dilemma, where those who have been deceived may feel unable to come forward.

Political unrest has also driven more Myanmar workers to migrate for work, and we have seen a sharp increase in Myanmar workers reaching out for support. Many are in especially precarious circumstances, trapped in exploitative conditions yet fearful of being repatriated to a home country in turmoil. Their cases remind us how important it is that our support remains accessible and responsive to the changing realities of the migrant workforce.



In times like these, community matters more than ever. Our community-building work continues to expand and, over the past year, we have benefited from deeper partnerships and stronger participation from migrant workers themselves — including from communities that have not previously been as visible in our programmes. These community events matter: they offer not just rest and recreation, but connection and a sense of belonging. Many of these initiatives are shaped and led by migrant workers, reflecting a community that is not only supported, but actively shaping the direction of our work.

Our work remains guided by our three core pillars: welfare, advocacy, and empowerment — responding to immediate needs while working towards longer-term improvements in policy and practice. In the year ahead, we will continue to advocate for stronger rest day protections, safer transport for workers, and fairer, more accessible pathways for those seeking redress. This must include clear safeguards for workers who have been deceived or placed in irregular situations, including situations that may amount to forced labour or trafficking.

We approach the coming year with a clear sense of purpose. While the environment in which we operate remains difficult, we are sustained by the community around us — the staff, volunteers, partners, donors, and migrant workers who continue to place their trust in HOME.



With appreciation,
Dr Stephanie Chok
Executive Director, HOME



Our Impact in 2025

1200+
Calls from migrant domestic workers (MDWs) to our helplines

501
Women housed at our shelter

2147
Migrant workers assisted across our multiple helpdesks

318
MDWs received counselling support

4000+
Migrant worker attendees at HOME Family events and outings

72
Events and activities organised for HOME Family community members

170
Volunteers supported our services

736
MDWs attended our HOME Academy Courses

1.47 million+
views across social media platforms

9092
Total Volunteer Hours

Welfare



Women's Crisis Shelter

As of December 2025, there were **316,900 migrant domestic workers (MDWs)** in Singapore. Many work behind closed doors, in private homes where oversight is limited and isolation is common. Within these spaces, risks of physical, emotional, and psychological abuse often go unseen.

Against this backdrop, HOME's Women's Crisis Shelter remains a critical lifeline — a place of safety, dignity, and recovery for migrant women who have experienced abuse, exploitation, and unsafe living conditions.

In 2025, HOME provided shelter to **501 women migrant workers**. Beyond those who entered the Shelter, approximately **1,200 domestic workers reached out through our helplines**, where HOME provides advice and support.

At its core, the shelter is not only a place of refuge, but a space for healing and rebuilding. Our team of volunteer counsellors provided **emotional support to 318 residents**, helping women process trauma, regain a sense of self, and begin to imagine what comes next.



Samira Shahul, Volunteer Counsellor

What drew me to HOME was its recognition that migrant workers need more than practical support — they also need care for the emotional and psychological impact of displacement, exploitation, and abuse. I felt my counselling background could help residents process their experiences and regain a sense of stability and dignity.

Counselling in a shelter environment is especially important during what is often a very uncertain time, as many residents navigate complex challenges — from legal and employment issues to financial and family concerns. Language and cultural differences can also make trust-building more difficult.

At the same time, there are meaningful breakthroughs — seeing someone move from feeling overwhelmed to expressing their needs more clearly, or beginning to feel hopeful again. Supporting residents has deepened my appreciation for culturally sensitive, trauma-informed care, and reminded me that counselling is ultimately about presence, empathy, and meeting people where they are.

A defining feature of HOME's Shelter is its emphasis on peer-led community. Residents take on leadership roles in their daily lives — cooking, organising activities, and supporting one another. In a setting where many have experienced disempowerment, these acts of shared responsibility become deeply restorative, rebuilding confidence, agency, and trust.

The shelter is sustained by a network of support that reflects the broader community's commitment to this work. Alongside institutional funding, in-kind contributions play an important role — from fresh vegetables provided through food rescue initiatives to rice from religious institutions. These contributions ensure that residents' basic needs are met with care and consistency.



Sharifah*, Shelter Resident
****Pseudonym***

I came to HOME when I had a problem in Singapore and my agency could no longer help me. At the shelter, I met friends from different countries and we supported and comforted one another, which helped me feel less alone during a very difficult time. I feel safe and comfortable here. I can eat properly, rest, and slowly recover. The counselling sessions helped me a lot. I was very hopeless before, but after sharing my problems, I began to feel calmer and found the courage to face my situation again. HOME also supported me through my case, from bringing me to the shelter, to accompanying me for court, and connecting me with a lawyer. Because of this support, my situation improved greatly. I am very thankful. To others who need help, I just want to say, do not lose hope and reach out to HOME.





Stephanie Kolentsis, Art Workshop Volunteer

I was inspired to volunteer at the HOME Shelter to give back to women in need and support an organisation that advocates for equity for migrant and foreign domestic workers. During my art workshops, we created a series of drawings, paintings, collages, and prints that were beginner-friendly and focused on self-expression and mindfulness.

Art brings people together to share and create. It can feel vulnerable to create with others, and I was always so happy to see women expressing themselves in a way that felt open and honest.

For me, the experience of volunteering at the HOME Shelter has been deeply rewarding. Sharing my love of art with other women has been a true gift, and I'm grateful for the opportunity.

Moments of Care and Connection

Beyond casework, the shelter is also a space for healing, connection, and community. Through workshops, partnerships, and shared celebrations, residents are given moments of relief amid uncertainty — opportunities to learn new skills, express themselves, and rebuild a sense of confidence and belonging. Volunteers and partners play a vital role in creating these spaces, from digital literacy classes and art-based programmes to recreational activities and festive gatherings. Together, these experiences support residents' wellbeing while reminding them that they are not alone.



Community and Celebration



The Zemans' Family Annual Christmas Lunch



The Netherlands Charity Association's pre-loved clothes pop-up bazaar



Law firm TSMP's Gardens by the Bay outing with shelter residents



Deepavali celebrations with the Indian Women's Association



Oldendorff's CSR event, which included a tote bag painting session



McKinsey Day of Service at East Coast Park



Hari Raya Celebrations with community group, Suara Kita



Games Day with Temasek Junior College

Wellbeing and Recreation



Fitness boot camp at the shelter



Art therapy session at the shelter



Outdoors with our volunteer Walking Club



A session with Her Playback Theatre group



An outing to Mandai Wildlife Reserve's River Wonders



A UN-Talent Show organised by a youth volunteer group



Raffles Institution Outing to East Coast Park



Wesley Methodist Church dance class

Learning and Empowerment



A writing workshop for shelter residents



Digital literacy class conducted by Youth for Migrants, using laptops donated by Starhub



Learning to crochet at the shelter



Cooking class organised by the Italian Women's Group



Artworks produced by shelter residents



A visioning workshop at the shelter

Helplines: First Response in Moments of Crisis

HOME operates dedicated helplines for both migrant domestic workers and non-domestic migrant workers, providing an accessible first point of contact for those seeking advice or assistance.

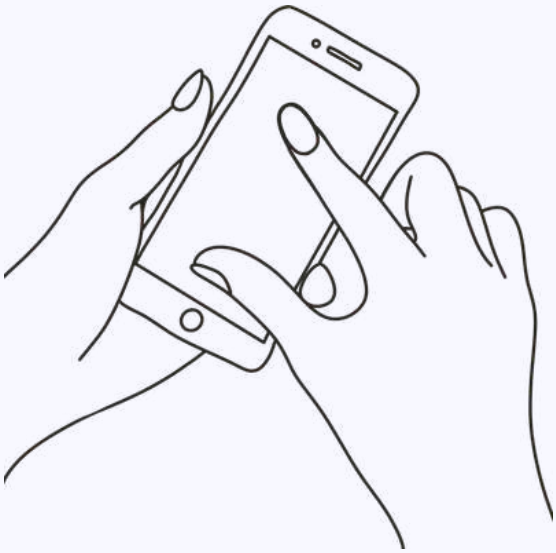
In 2025, we received **approximately 2,200 calls for assistance** across our helplines. In many cases, workers are encouraged to first resolve issues directly with their employers or employment agents, as this can be the most immediate and practical pathway to addressing concerns while sustaining the employment relationship. However, where workers feel unsafe, at risk, or unable to do so, they are referred to our helpdesks for further support, including casework assistance and, where necessary, access to shelter for women.

Complementing these services, MDW volunteers from our Sunday Helpdesks also provide peer support through WhatsApp, extending HOME's reach into the community and ensuring that workers have trusted channels to seek help when needed.

Migrant Worker Helpline:
+65 6341 5535

Migrant Domestic Worker Helpline:
+65 9787 3122

Available 7 Days a week,
on Whatsapp, SMS or phonecalls.



Helpdesks: Casework Support

HOME operates a network of dedicated helpdesks that serve migrant workers facing abuse, exploitation, and employment-related disputes. These helpdesks provide free support for workers who may otherwise lack the resources or knowledge to navigate complex systems in Singapore.



The Migrant Domestic Worker Helpdesk is co-located with our women's shelter, enabling timely and coordinated intervention for workers in crisis. This allows for prompt assessment and referral to appropriate support services, including safe accommodation, casework assistance, and counselling where needed.

HOME also operates a Migrant Worker Helpdesk for workers outside of domestic work, including those in the construction, marine shipyard, process, manufacturing, and service sectors. Support provided includes assistance with salary disputes, workplace injuries, illegal deployment, and other employment-related issues, with guidance on available avenues for recourse.

On Sundays, HOME extends its reach through peer-led helpdesks located in community spaces where migrant domestic workers gather on their rest days. These helpdesks are run by trained migrant worker volunteers, who provide frontline support in a manner that is linguistically and culturally accessible. They work closely with HOME's casework and shelter teams to facilitate appropriate referrals and follow-up support.

Across 2025, the cases seen at the helpdesks reflect a broader pattern: workers continue to navigate systems that are complex, inconsistent, and difficult to access without support.

HOME's role remains to bridge this gap — providing not only immediate assistance, but sustained advocacy to ensure that migrant workers are able to access fair and meaningful remedies.

Casework Training for Volunteers and Interns

HOME's casework team also plays a key role in strengthening volunteer capacity by conducting regular training sessions. These sessions serve as platforms to discuss emerging trends, share insights from ongoing cases, and provide guidance and support to volunteers in their work.

These annual training sessions were also designed as comprehensive refreshers, covering common issues encountered, best practices in case documentation, and updates to casework processes, ensuring that volunteers remain well-equipped to deliver consistent and effective support.

At the same time, every new volunteer undergoes a structured and comprehensive onboarding process. This training equips them with the necessary knowledge, skills, and confidence to effectively support cases, ensuring they are well-prepared to respond to the needs of those they assist.

Outreach and Partnerships

In 2025, HOME continued to strengthen its network of partners and collaborators to address emerging and complex needs among migrant workers.

Key engagements included:

- Partnering with Pro Bono SG to support access to legal representation and recourse.
- Collaborating with organisations such as Criticare Fund, Ray of Hope, Muslim Trust Fund Association, and Migrant Mutual Aid to support medical and financial needs.
- Working with Transient Workers Count Too (TWC2) and HealthServe on case referrals to ensure coordinated service provision.
- Attended AWARE's capacity-building workshop to strengthen support pathways for survivors of sexual assault.
- Cross-border collaboration with NGOs from MDWs' sending countries to ensure protections from recruitment agencies.

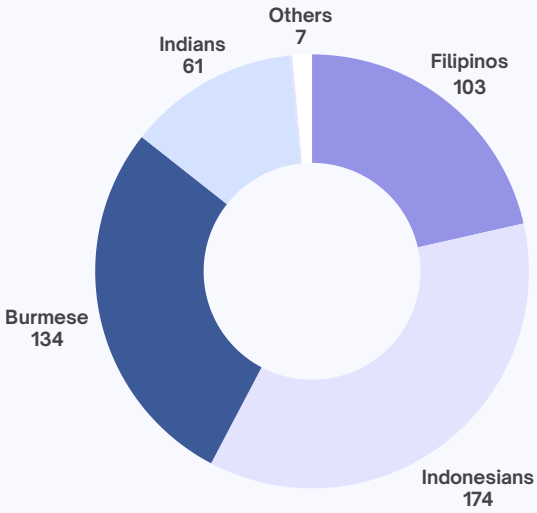
These collaborations complement HOME's direct services and strengthen a broader ecosystem of support for migrant workers in Singapore.

Migrant Domestic Worker Helpdesk: Key Statistics and Impact

1200+
Calls from MDWs to our helplines

501
Women housed at our shelter

318
MDWs received counselling



Nationalities of MDWs Who Sought Refuge at HOME's Shelter

Top Issues Faced by MDWs in 2025

331
reported verbal abuse from employers

227
experienced intimidation / threats

236
reported being overworked

184
reported no full rest days with substantial work done on rest days

184
reported food-related issues

201
had identity and employment documents confiscated

MDW Helpdesk: Top Issues

Many MDWs face not just one, but several of these issues simultaneously — compounding their vulnerability and making it harder to seek redress or protection.



Verbal Abuse & Threats

The most commonly reported issue at the shelter is verbal abuse where workers face scolding, being called names or shouted at by their employers. Such behaviours are often coupled with threats of repatriation, blacklisting, or being reported to the authorities. These tactics exploit the employer's unilateral ability to cancel work permits or leave negative records, putting MDWs' livelihoods and futures at risk.



Overwork

Overwork is rampant, with many working 12–18 hours daily without adequate rest. As MDWs are not covered under the Employment Act, they have no limits on working hours. Those tasked with eldercare are often sleep-deprived, sometimes having to perform almost round-the-clock care, and asked to perform tasks without training.



Food-Related Abuse

Food-related abuse remains prevalent: some are given only leftovers, inadequate nutrition, denied food as punishment, or forced to eat meals that contradict religious dietary restrictions.



Confiscation of Identity and Employment Documents

Many MDWs still have their passports and work permits confiscated by their employers, even though this is against the law. Employment documents such as In Principle Approval (IPA) and contracts are regularly not given to workers, leaving them unsure about their rights in areas such as rest days and salaries.



Rest Day Issues

Despite the 2023 regulation mandating one non-waivable monthly rest day, rest day violations persist, with MDWs report being denied rest days altogether (especially early in their contracts). Others report having to do substantial work on their days off (as there is no legal definition of a duration of a rest day for MDWs), or having strict curfews that severely limit the free time they have on their only rest day.

Migrant Domestic Worker Helpdesk: Casework Trends



In 2025, the MDW Helpdesk assisted a total of **480** domestic workers. In this section, we discuss casework trends we have observed in the course of the year.

Rise in Sexual Abuse Cases



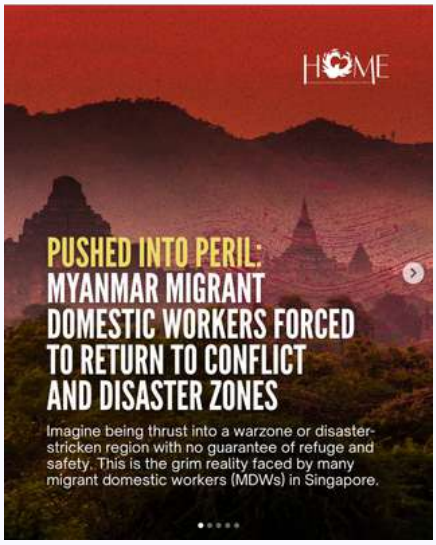
In the latter half of 2025, HOME observed a concerning increase in sexual abuse cases among shelter residents. This has led to our casework team working to implement structured protocols for sexual abuse cases to ensure that survivors are sufficiently informed about their rights and options, and can access redress, as well as the necessary emotional support.

In one case, HOME supported a sexual assault survivor in exploring her options to seek redress, eventually connecting her with pro bono lawyers to pursue a civil lawsuit.

HOME provided counselling support and ensured continuity in case handling to minimise re-traumatisation. HOME also worked with the pro-bono lawyer in gathering and distilling evidence. She has since returned home, and her case remains ongoing, with her lawyers working on a settlement.

Deportation of Myanmar Workers

HOME has also observed a troubling increase in cases involving Myanmar migrant domestic workers at our shelter who are compelled to return to Myanmar against their will. Many of these workers had sought job transfers; however, as the ability to change employers remains contingent on employer consent, they were instead forced into repatriation once their employment came to an end. Under MOM regulations, employers are required to repatriate workers back to their home countries, but workers can choose to go to another destination with the consent of their employers, who are obliged to purchase their repatriation ticket.



Read post here

These MDWs have said that they were unable to safely return to Myanmar due to ongoing conflict or potential political persecution. Despite requesting repatriation to a third country, employers insist on sending them back to Myanmar. They are left with no alternative but to return to circumstances that place them at even greater risk and vulnerability.

HOME will continue to advocate for the easing of repatriation rules when they work to the detriment of migrant workers. HOME recommends that in the event of a dispute over repatriation destinations, workers should be allowed to purchase a flight to their country of their choosing. Workers should also be allowed to transfer employers with clear notice periods; the current repatriation regime that gives employers near-total discretion over a worker's repatriation and destination makes it an avenue for retaliation against workers who report abuse.

Case Study: Min's Story

Min came to HOME's shelter as she could no longer tolerate the verbal abuse from her employers, which included consistent threats of being reported to the police when her employers were angry at her. She also found her food situation inadequate, where she was made to eat leftovers and expired food. Min wanted to transfer to another employer.

HOME raised her case to MOM but, ultimately, the decision on whether Min would be able to transfer was left to her employer, who decided to repatriate her. Min's hometown in Myanmar had been completely destroyed by natural disaster, and her family members had become displaced. She was also unable to contact them. Min requested to go to Thailand as she had extended family there, but her employer insisted on sending her back to Myanmar. This was even though Min said she would pay for her own ticket to Thailand.

Unfortunately, even after the matter was referred to the MOM, she was told that the decision over the repatriation destination would default to Myanmar, if no agreement was reached with the employer. This allowed Min's employer to continue to wield power over her circumstances even after her employment had ended, and on her future.

Caregiving Burdens on MDWs

As in previous years, HOME has observed a continued rise in migrant domestic workers undertaking specialised care roles, particularly in eldercare. In many cases, these workers are deployed without adequate training, leaving them ill-prepared to manage the complex and demanding realities of caregiving. As a result, many arrive at our shelter physically and emotionally exhausted.

Case Study: Safira's Story



Full story here

Safira, an Indonesian MDW was tasked with caring for her employer's immobile elderly mother, who weighed 104kg, far more than what she had been told before starting work.

Despite having no formal training and being warned by hospital staff that such lifting required multiple caregivers, Safira was forced to carry out physically demanding transfers alone, including lifting her employer's mother from bed to wheelchair and into the bathroom. Within four months, she suffered significant weight loss and chronic pain, yet was warned not to fall ill or seek help, with her employer telling her, "You cannot sick, ya. If you sick, then *mati (dead)* ah."

In addition to caregiving, Safira was responsible for all household chores for a family of five, often repeating tasks to meet unreasonable expectations and performing unsafe duties. Her workday stretched from 5:30 AM to 10 PM, with frequent interruptions at night to care for her employer's mother, leaving her with little rest. She was denied breaks and scolded if she sat down. The abuse extended beyond physical overwork into persistent verbal and psychological harm. Safira was insulted daily, called "stupid" and "*gila (mad)*", and subjected to religious mockery. As a Muslim, she was deliberately given food containing pork and called "*babi*", while being told eating pork would make her "smarter". Her employer also humiliated her with degrading remarks, accusing her of having a boyfriend and making explicit comments about her body.

After four months, Safira fled to HOME's shelter and sought assistance to pursue her case and request a transfer so she could continue working. Despite providing evidence of abuse, including audio recordings, her complaints to MOM and SPF were not taken up for further investigation, and her transfer request was denied despite repeated appeals by HOME. With no viable pathway to continue employment in Singapore, Safira eventually returned to Indonesia. Her case reflects the severe caregiving burdens placed on migrant domestic workers, and the gaps in protection for those experiencing overlapping forms of physical, psychological, and emotional abuse.

Legal Support for MDWs



HOME supports migrant domestic workers (MDWs) who require legal representation, most often after they have been charged with offences. We assist them in applying for pro bono legal aid or connect them with volunteer lawyers from our network. HOME works with lawyers from 15 law firms to ensure that our clients have access to legal assistance when required.

Many migrant workers face significant barriers to accessing legal representation, and some are left to navigate an unfamiliar court system on their own. In such circumstances, individuals may plead guilty simply because they feel they have no viable alternative.

HOME seeks to address this gap by ensuring that MDWs are aware of their rights and are empowered to make informed decisions about their cases.

We also ensure that MDW residents at our shelter are given the opportunity to seek employment where possible. Many migrant workers undergoing investigations are unaware that such options are available to them.

Case Study: Nan's Story

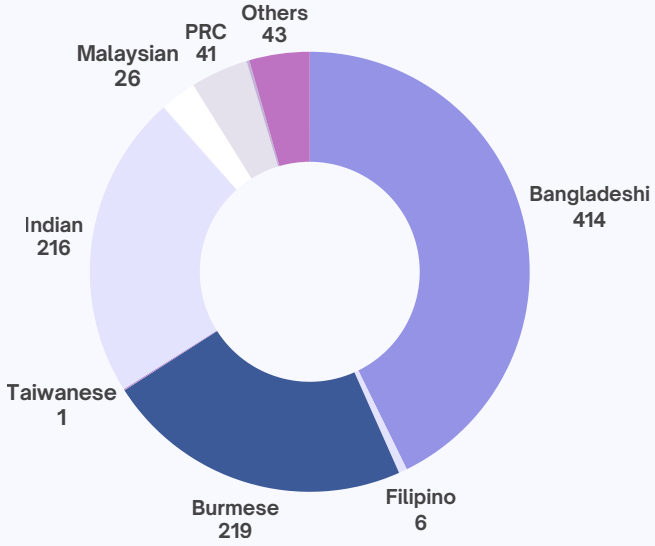
Nan arrived at HOME's shelter facing charges for the unlawful use of her employer's credit card. HOME promptly assisted her in applying for legal representation under the Criminal Legal Aid Scheme through Pro Bono SG. Working closely with her lawyer, HOME supported Nan in reviewing legal documents and representations, provided translation services, and liaised with her investigation officer from the Singapore Police Force to negotiate a restitution payment plan, which ultimately contributed to a mitigated sentence.

Nan chose to plead guilty to the charges, and HOME, together with her lawyer, ensured she fully understood the implications of this decision. Following her sentencing and release, Nan returned to the HOME shelter to express her heartfelt gratitude for the support she had received, before being repatriated.

Migrant Worker Helpdesk



In 2025, HOME's Migrant Worker Helpdesk assisted **918 workers** who experienced abuse and exploitation in their workplaces. These workers were predominantly from the construction and service sectors, with Bangladeshi, Burmese, and Indian workers forming the largest groups. Referrals increasingly came through informal networks, including fellow workers, members of the public, and social media platforms.



Breakdown of Migrant Workers Assisted by Nationality

Many of the workers who approach HOME are not facing a single issue, but multiple, overlapping challenges. Salary disputes are often compounded by missing or falsified payslips, or by workers being coerced into signing blank documents. Deceptive recruitment may lead to sudden dismissal, while workplace injuries can result in prolonged periods without income or clarity on compensation.

These issues are often interconnected. What begins as thousands of dollars of recruitment debt or misinformation before arrival can escalate into workplace exploitation, financial insecurity, and barriers to seeking redress. This reflects a broader pattern, where vulnerabilities at different stages of a worker's journey reinforce one another, making it difficult for workers to resolve their situations without support from NGOs like HOME.

Migrant Worker Helpdesk: Top Issues



1304
Salary-related Complaints

Forms of **wage theft**, including non-payment and underpayment of wages, and **wage deductions**

Issues related to **work injuries**, including unreported injuries, denial/delay of medical treatment, lengthy investigations, lack of financial support.



228
Work Injury-related Complaints



179
Reported Unfair Dismissal

Including **sudden dismissal**, within weeks (sometimes days) of starting work, after having paid substantial recruitment fees. Linked to deceptive recruitment, with agents and employers potentially profiteering through this worker churn.



204
Complaints of Deception

Deception about nature/scope of work, including working conditions, salary, and legality of work pass conditions.

Top Issues: Overview

Wage Theft and Documentation Gaps

Salary-related violations remained the most prevalent issue across our Migrant Worker Helpdesk caseload, with **1,304 instances** in 2025. These included:

- Non-payment and underpayment of wages, including overtime paid at incorrect rates.
- Denial of rest day and public holiday pay.
- Salaries significantly below what was stated in the worker's In-Principle Approval (IPA) letter.
- Unlawful deductions.



These cases are particularly difficult to resolve because wage theft is often accompanied by missing or falsified documentation. Workers frequently reported receiving no itemised payslips, having no access to time records, being asked to sign blank or untranslated documents, and not being given copies of their IPA or employment contracts. In some cases, passports and employment documents were withheld entirely.

The absence of payslips and time records remains a key barrier when workers attempt to pursue salary claims at the Employment Claims Tribunals (ECT). These documentation gaps do not occur in isolation; they significantly weaken workers' ability to prove their claims and access meaningful redress.

Deceptive Recruitment and Work Pass Abuse

The payment of high recruitment fees remains a persistent issue. In 2025, HOME assisted workers who had paid between S$4,500 and S$10,000 to secure employment, leaving many heavily indebted upon arrival and highly vulnerable.



Many workers were recruited for jobs that either did not exist or differed significantly from what had been promised. HOME recorded **204 cases involving deception over job scope, salary, or working conditions**. There were also numerous instances of illegal deployment and occupation mismatches, where workers were issued IPAs for one role but deployed to entirely different sectors upon arrival, such as food processing workers sent to massage parlours or performing artistes placed in restaurant jobs. In more serious cases, workers were exposed to roles involving sexual exploitation.

HOME also observed misuse of higher-tier work passes, including S Passes, Training Employment Passes, and Employment Passes, by employers operating shell or phantom companies. Workers were hired under these passes, which require higher declared salaries, but subsequently placed in low-paid roles that did not match their IPA terms, potentially to circumvent quota or levy restrictions.

Workers in these situations face a difficult bind. Having incurred substantial debt, many feel unable to leave or report abuse for fear of repatriation with unpaid loans. At the same time, they may be exposed to legal risk for breaching the conditions of their work pass. HOME supported these workers in filing complaints with the Ministry of Manpower and, where necessary, the police, while advocating for access to Temporary Job Scheme (TJS) placements and repatriation stays during investigations.

Case Study 1: Deception and Sexual Exploitation



Mya came to Singapore believing she would be working in a beauty salon serving female customers. She had made it clear to her agent in Myanmar that she did not want to perform massage services, and was assured that her role would be limited to beauty treatments. She was even sent videos of such treatments by a contact in Singapore, reinforcing her understanding of the job. After raising S$4,700 in recruitment fees, Mya arrived in Singapore in July 2025. Only later did she realise that her IPA, which she could not read as it was in English, listed her occupation as a “food processing worker”.


FIWPS111Eb_W2 – IPA Work Permit [redacted] EMPLOYEE'S COPY

MINISTRY OF MANPOWER

Know your rights and responsibilities

You can only work in Singapore as a / an FOOD PROCESSING WORKER for [redacted] BEAUTY.

Upon arrival, she was taken to a massage parlour and informed that she would be working there. Despite her objections, she felt she had no choice but to comply due to the debt she had incurred. On her first day, while attending to a male client, he touched her inappropriately after she refused his request for sexual services. Distressed, Mya left immediately and sought help from a friend before approaching HOME.

With HOME’s support, she lodged a police report and filed a complaint with MOM regarding deceptive recruitment practices. She was allowed to work while investigations were ongoing. Her case has since concluded, and she has left Singapore.

Case Study 2: A Job That Never Existed

Kumarr arrived in Singapore in November 2025 on an Employment Pass for a managerial position with a salary of S$10,100 per month, having paid approximately S$8,500 in recruitment fees in India. Upon arrival, he was not provided with any employment. Instead, he was later asked to perform parcel delivery work. Within two weeks, his IPA was cancelled. He was not paid any salary, nor provided with accommodation or food. When he visited the company address listed on his IPA, he discovered that no such company existed. He subsequently approached HOME for assistance.



HOME referred his case to MOM, where he was informed that his “actual” employer was a different entity. While repatriation arrangements were initially made, HOME appealed for him to be recognised as a victim of a job scam and to be placed on the Temporary Job Scheme (TJS). Although his repatriation was temporarily stayed, TJS was not granted. He was given time to seek alternative employment under the EP scheme but was unsuccessful. Kumarr was repatriated in January 2026.

HOME will continue to advocate for victims of recruitment scams to ensure that they are given a fair chance at new employment, ensuring they are not repatriated with unresolved claims and indebtedness.

Unfair Dismissal

In 2025, HOME observed a rise in cases of workers being dismissed for alleged misconduct, underperformance, or unsuitability within mere weeks, or even days, of commencing employment. Many of these workers had incurred substantial recruitment fees to secure jobs in Singapore, only to face sudden job loss, mounting debt, and repatriation. This troubling pattern points to a broader trend of potentially profiteering from workers through the extraction of recruitment fees.



Work Injuries and Post-Injury Precarity



HOME continued to support workers pursuing claims under the Work Injury Compensation Act (WICA). The issues in these cases extended well beyond the injury itself. Workers reported employers failing to report workplace injuries, medical treatment being denied or delayed, medical certificates withheld, and medical leave wages not paid or paid at incorrect rates. Insurers frequently took months to investigate claims, during which workers were left with little or no financial support.

HOME has been actively engaging the Ministry of Manpower to address delays in WICA resolution and to advocate for guaranteed subsistence support during the investigation period.

Case Study: Securing Medical Leave Wages Following Injury



Azizul was injured in October 2024 while carrying heavy construction materials under time pressure. He later discovered that his bone was misaligned. For six months following his injury, he survived on a monthly allowance of S$150 from his employer, without receiving his entitled medical leave wages.

He approached HOME for assistance, as he struggled to meet his daily needs. In June 2025, Azizul received his compensation payout, but his medical leave wages — amounting to approximately S$8,600 — remained largely unpaid.

Following HOME's intervention, he received a partial payment of about S$3,000. His employer indicated that the remaining amount would only be paid upon his return to Bangladesh.

In July 2025, Azizul was repatriated. HOME subsequently understands from MOM that his medical leave wages were fully paid prior to his departure.

Legal Support



In 2025, HOME assisted an increasing number of workers whose cases were referred to the Employment Claims Tribunals (ECT), particularly for wrongful dismissal and salary-related disputes.

By the end of the year, the Helpdesk had handled **20 ongoing or completed ECT cases**. While some workers were able to secure partial or full compensation, many faced difficulties navigating the process, which requires English proficiency, digital literacy, and familiarity with quasi-legal procedures.

These cases are resource-intensive. In response, HOME expanded its pool of legally trained volunteers and strengthened internal capacity in evidence gathering, witness statement preparation, and case management.

Case Study: Recovering $16,000 in Unpaid Wages

Sally, a cleaner, approached HOME after her employer failed to pay her overtime wages. The employer contended that she held a supervisory role and was therefore not entitled to overtime pay. HOME took an active role in supporting Sally by assisting her in filing a claim with the Employment Claims Tribunals (ECT) and working closely with her to build a robust case. This included gathering and substantiating evidence to refute the employer's claims.



We further supported Sally in drafting her witness statement, supporting her witnesses in preparing their statements, reviewed evidence for her case and supported the costs of professional transcription and translation of audio recordings.

In addition, HOME provided hands-on assistance in navigating the Community Justice and Tribunals System (CJTS), ensuring that all evidence and documentation were properly uploaded and that correspondence with the court was timely and accurate. Through this comprehensive support, Sally was ultimately successful in her claim and was awarded S$16,000 in unpaid salary. She has since returned home and is moving forward with greater stability.



Similar to the MDW helpdesk, HOME assists with legal representation for workers who face charges through our network of pro bono lawyers. In 2025, HOME supported several drivers who faced charges under the Road Traffic Act (RTA). As offences under the RTA are not eligible for the Criminal Legal Aid Scheme under Pro Bono SG, HOME tapped on our network of volunteer lawyers for assistance in such cases.

Case Study: Providing Legal and Practical Support

Monu was a driver who was charged with dangerous driving under the Road Traffic Act. During this difficult period, HOME connected him with a volunteer pro bono lawyer and provided consistent support — attending legal consultations, offering translation services, and assisting with the preparation of legal representations.

Following the charge, Monu took up work as a general labourer, resulting in a significant reduction in his income. To ease this financial strain, HOME supported him in applying for financial assistance to offset his loss of earnings. Ultimately, Monu was sentenced to a fine, in line with the recommendations put forth by his defence counsel.

Sunday Helpdesks: Peer-Led Support, Built by the Community



In 2025, HOME continued to operate our Indonesian and Myanmar Sunday helpdesks at City Plaza and Peninsula Plaza respectively. In October, we relocated our Filipino Sunday Helpdesk— previously based at Lucky Plaza since 2006 — to our office in Geylang, allowing for closer integration with our broader services and more coordinated support.

These helpdesks are often the first point of contact for domestic workers facing issues such as abuse, exploitation or uncertainty about their rights.

What makes them distinctive is that they are peer-led — run by volunteer MDWs who bring lived experience, language skills, and trust. Through listening, translating, and guiding, they help fellow workers take their first steps towards resolving their situations.

Where necessary, the helpdesk volunteers will escalate matters to our caseworkers or refer the distressed domestic worker to our shelter.

More than service points, these Sunday helpdesks reflect our belief that migrant workers are not just recipients of support, but active agents of care within their own communities.

In September 2025, HOME introduced a monthly support group for Sunday helpdesk volunteers, facilitated by professional therapists and counsellors. This initiative recognises the emotional demands of peer support work, and ensures that volunteers are provided with a dedicated space for reflection, care, and psychological support. Through these sessions, HOME seeks to sustain the wellbeing of its volunteers, equipping them to continue supporting others while also attending to their own emotional needs.

Indonesian Sunday Helpdesk



Ludiawati, Helpdesk Volunteer

I first came to HOME in 2014 as a student, taking classes like dressmaking, jewellery, and caregiving. Later, I became a jewellery teacher with HOME Academy. During COVID-19 in 2020, I joined the Indonesian helpdesk as a volunteer, and I've been serving there for the past six years.

I wanted to give back, especially to support fellow migrant domestic workers who are not as fortunate, who face difficult journeys while working here. At the helpdesk, I try to stay positive and open-minded so I can listen and support each person who comes to us.

There was one case that stayed with me — a worker who was scammed and lost more than $8,000 because she trusted someone. It reminded me how vulnerable many of us can be, and how important it is that we look out for one another.

Through volunteering, I've learned to be more patient, not to judge, and to listen with empathy. I've also gained so much knowledge from HOME. *For me, this is why we volunteer — so we can support each other and make sure no one has to face these challenges alone.*

Filipino Sunday Helpdesk



Jo Ann, Helpdesk Volunteer

I have been volunteering at the Filipino Helpdesk for almost six years, driven by a desire to make a difference in my community. On a typical day, we listen to fellow workers facing issues like overwork, lack of rest, food restrictions, or problems with transfer and documents. Some cannot even leave their homes, so they reach out to us by phone.

I once assisted a domestic worker who was chased out by her employer for returning home ten minutes after her curfew. Being able to support them, guide them, or bring them to safety reminds me why this work is important.

My rest day is my chance to uplift others. We support one another, build friendships, and remind each other that help is available.

For me, volunteering means having a big heart, listening with empathy, and standing with others when they need it most.

Myanmar Sunday Helpdesk



Moe Swe, Helpdesk Volunteer

I stayed at HOME Shelter for seven months after my employer beat me. That experience changed me. I know how it feels to be in trouble, especially when you don't understand the language and don't know where to go for help.

That is why I chose to volunteer at the Myanmar Helpdesk. Many Burmese workers face problems with their employers but cannot solve them on their own. Sometimes even when they go to agents, they are not helped, and are asked to pay more money. In these situations, it is very important that we have someone who understands and can support us.

Now, Myanmar is at war, and many Burmese people are going through very difficult situations. Being here, I feel that I can do something meaningful — to support and protect my fellow Burmese workers when they need help.

For me, volunteering is about standing with my community, so no one has to face these challenges alone.



Empowerment



HOME Academy: Building Skills, Confidence, and Pathways



A Peer-Led Model of Empowerment

HOME Academy continues to be a cornerstone of our empowerment pillar, creating pathways for MDWs to build skills, confidence, and community. Rooted in a peer-led model, the Academy is more than a training platform — it is a space where workers invest in themselves, support one another, and expand their sense of what is possible.

Many courses are taught by MDWs who have themselves progressed through the programme, with some having volunteered with HOME for decades. **39 MDWs** volunteered their training expertise to HOME Academy in 2025. This model builds trust and accessibility, while positioning MDWs as educators and leaders — challenging traditional narratives of migrant workers as passive recipients of aid.



Jumiyati, HOME Academy Graduate, Baking

When I first joined the baking class, I felt it was very difficult and almost impossible. Baking was my weakness, but I did not give up. I kept practicing, and slowly I became more confident.

Through HOME Academy, I learned not just baking, but also patience, resilience, and to believe in myself. I am very grateful to my teachers and everyone who supported me. This journey showed me that with practice and determination, anything is possible.



Access to Learning and Community

In 2025, **736 MDWs** participated in HOME Academy courses, held at United World College of South East Asia (East Campus), Peninsula Plaza and HOME's office. Students pursued **16** vocational training and personal development courses offered at subsidised rates.

Nursing Aide and Caregiver courses remained the most in demand, reflecting strong interest in healthcare-related skills. At the same time, recreational courses such as Guitar and Baking provided important spaces for expression, creativity, and community-building — supporting overall wellbeing alongside learning.



Jetky Marie B. Amores, HOME Academy Volunteer Teacher, Cooking

I have been volunteering with HOME Academy since 2011. Teaching cooking is challenging, but very meaningful. It takes patience, understanding, and good communication. As the main cooking teacher, I prepare the recipes, grocery shopping, cooking demonstrations, and teaching materials.

One of the most fulfilling moments is seeing students gain confidence and proudly prepare dishes on their own. Some students have shared their dreams of opening small food businesses, cafés, or home-based food shops when they return home. I also learn from my students. Teaching is always a give-and-take. While I share my cooking skills, they share their cultures, ideas, and techniques with me.

Certification and Future Pathways

In 2025, **41 students** completed certification programmes, including 16 who completed the TESDA Caregiver course and 25 who completed the TESDA Healthcare Assistant course.

These certifications, awarded by the Philippines government's Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA), are internationally recognised and enable MDWs to pursue future employment opportunities in the healthcare sector, both in Singapore and in other countries.



Janine Pillo, HOME Academy Graduate, Caregiving

I have learned many valuable lessons through my education and work experience. Graduating from Home Academy in Singapore with a TESDA certification in Caregiving helped me build a strong foundation for my future. My Academy experience taught me discipline, responsibility, and the importance of having a positive mindset. I faced many challenges, but those challenges helped me grow stronger and more confident. I was able to pursue new opportunities for myself. Now, I am here in Turkey, continuing to work hard as a caregiver and pursue a better future.



From Training to Practice

HOME Academy strengthened its training ecosystem through partnerships and expanded experiential learning opportunities.

In collaboration with SATA CommHealth, students in Caregiving, Nursing Aide, and Healthcare Assistant tracks received enhanced training support. Migrant Health Matters conducted health screenings for all students, reinforcing the importance of wellbeing alongside skills development.

To bridge training with real-world practice, **57 students** from the Basic Caregiver course undertook on-the-job training placements with Active Global Active Ageing Centres. These placements provided hands-on experience in community care settings, with some students progressing into professional caregiving roles.



Basic Caregiver OJT with Active Global Active Aging Centres



CPR Training with SCDF



Health Screening with Healthserve



Fall Prevention and Recovery Class with SATA Commhealth

Strengthening Curriculum and Quality

In 2025, HOME Academy received support from The Majurity Trust's Scaffold Fund to strengthen four core courses: Basic Caregiving, Advanced Caregiving, Nursing Aide, and Healthcare Assistant.

This support enabled upgrades to training facilities, curriculum reviews by industry professionals, and the development of virtual training aids. These enhancements ensure that courses remain relevant, practical, and aligned with industry standards — while equipping MDWs with critical caregiving competencies for both current roles and future career pathways.





Mesiati,
HOME Academy Volunteer Teacher, Caregiving

I have been volunteering with HOME Academy since 2017. I wanted to help other migrant domestic workers improve their caregiving skills, so they can have better opportunities, even in healthcare in the future.

Teaching means a lot to me because it is not only about sharing knowledge, but also learning from my students. We support each other and grow together. I am especially proud when I see my students succeed. Every few months, some of them are able to find jobs as caregivers after they graduate, and seeing them happy and confident makes me very proud.

Empowerment in Practice

Through HOME Academy, empowerment is not abstract. It is reflected in the acquisition of skills, the attainment of recognised qualifications, and the growth of peer leadership within the community.

More importantly, it is about enabling migrant domestic workers to not only navigate their present circumstances, but to shape their futures with confidence, dignity, and greater choice.

Home Academy Attendance for 2025

119 Nursing Aide	88 Basic Caregiver	35 Advanced Caregiver	71 Healthcare	
85 English	19 Dressmaking	7 Cosmetology	101 Computer	27 Hairdressing
46 Baking Bahasa	59 Baking English	38 Cooking	9 Advanced Dressmaking	32 Guitar



HOME Academy Classes



Caregiver



Dressmaking



Baking



Computer skills



Cooking



Cosmetology

HOME Academy Classes



Guitar



English



Hairdressing



Healthcare



Nursing Aide

HOME Family: Community as Care, Community as Outreach



Alongside HOME Academy, HOME Family forms a cornerstone of HOME's community development work — bringing together migrant workers across nationalities into a network of peer-led groups rooted in support, leadership, and shared experience.

In 2025, HOME Family organised **79 events, reaching over 4,000 migrant workers**. These programmes go beyond recreation. They are intentional platforms where migrant workers build relationships, develop skills, and take on leadership roles within their own communities.

At its core, HOME Family is also a critical outreach arm. Community groups such as Suara Kita and Kaugnay are often the first to encounter workers in distress — those facing abuse, isolation, or uncertainty. Through trusted peer networks, these groups identify individuals in need and connect them to HOME's helpdesks, shelter, and casework services. In this way, community becomes a vital bridge to protection and care.

HOME Family Groups

An umbrella organisation of 15 Indonesian MDW community groups, organising a variety of events, from empowerment classes to support for migrant workers in distress.

A Filipino group that organises workshops and events, including the annual Trashion Show.



HOME Guitar

A Filipino group that teaches guitar skills and performs for HOME community events.



HOME Dental

Coordinating subsidised dental services for HOME Family volunteers and HOME Academy students.



HOME Academy

MDWs who volunteer their time and services on Sundays to conduct classes at HOME Academy.



HOME Family Photography

Volunteers who support photography and videography coverage for HOME Family events.



HOME Kartini

An Indonesian community group that organises personal development workshops, wellness sessions, dance and music events.

HOME Family Groups



HOME Roses

A Filipino community group that organises workshops with a focus on health and wellness.

HOME Talent Show



A Filipino group of MDWs who organise the annual HOME Talent Show and the Parade of National & Cultural Costume Show, open to all migrant workers.



HOME Nightingale

A community group that organises visits to MDWs who are hospitalised and in need of peer support.



Sunday Helpdesk (Filipino)

Providing online and in-person peer support for Filipino MDWs. Based in Lucky Plaza (till October) and Geylang (from November).



Sunday Helpdesk (Indonesian)

Providing online and in-person peer support for Indonesian MDWs. Based in City Plaza.



Sunday Helpdesk (Myanmar)

Providing online and in-person peer support for Burmese MDWs. Based in Peninsula Plaza.

HOME Sports



Organises sports events, including Volleyball, Badminton and Table Tennis, usually held at Sembawang Recreation Centre.



Skate Club

Organises weekly Sunday in-line skating sessions open to all migrant workers.



HOME Photography

A club to develop photography skills.

Key Areas of Engagement

1. Health and Wellbeing

HOME Family programmes support both physical and emotional wellbeing through sporting activities and wellness workshops that promote connection, stress relief, and community. HOME Sports runs regular volleyball training and tournaments at Sembawang Recreation Centre.



Yanti, HOME Sports

I started by taking photos of volleyball games, but over time I wanted to do more for the community. Organising these tournaments is not easy, but I want people to come to me to be happy. Because we work hard from Monday to Saturday, right?

When they play volleyball, they forget everything, about the hard work, employers scolding, missing the family. When I see them enjoying the game, making friends, and feeling part of something, it reminds me why I volunteer.

A key milestone in 2025 was the Labour Day Fitness Walk, which brought together more than **300 members** at East Coast Park for a day of walking, games, and shared meals. Health remained a key focus, particularly for ageing domestic workers. In partnership with UWC and Surety, menopause awareness workshops created safe spaces for women to learn, share, and better understand their health. Together, these initiatives empower workers to care for themselves while strengthening the social networks that sustain them.



Labour Day Fitness Walk



Run Lah, My Friends (in partnership with Change Our World)



Supporting Migrant Women Through Midlife and Menopause (in partnership with Surety)



Empowering Women's Health: From Menopause to Mental Wellbeing (in partnership with UWC)



HOME Sports Volleyball in partnership with NUS



HOME Sports Volleyball in partnership with OWWA



HOME Skate Club

2. Skills Development and Leadership

HOME collaborates with partners to deliver a wide range of free workshops, removing financial barriers to learning. These sessions span digital skills such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), graphic design, video editing, and creating presentations, alongside creative skills such as jewellery making, basic accountancy, and leadership training. Some workshops, such as Basic First Aid for Dogs and Cats, directly support workers in their caregiving roles.



Canva Workshop with UWC

Beyond skills acquisition, these programmes build confidence and agency, equipping workers to navigate their work environments and explore future opportunities. Many initiatives are led by HOME Family groups themselves, enabling members to become facilitators, organisers, and leaders while strengthening the collective capacity of migrant worker communities in Singapore.



Kartini Jewellery Making Workshop

Workshops and Partnerships



Suara Kita Leadership Training Workshop



ChatGPT Workshop with UWC



Google Slides Workshop with UWC



Video Editing Workshop with UWC



Kartini Basic Accountancy Workshop



Basic First Aid for Dogs and Cats with Beecroft Animal Specialist and Emergency Hospital

3. Community Building and Recreation

HOME Family creates opportunities for MDWs to connect beyond their workplaces. Festive celebrations such as Hari Raya and Christmas, community milestones like Suara Kita's 6th anniversary, and creative activities such as batik workshops allow workers to celebrate their cultures and build lasting friendships.

Outings to River Wonders and Gardens by the Bay, made possible through partnerships with Wildlife Reserves Singapore and Gardens by the Bay, offer rare opportunities for rest, exploration, and joy. These shared experiences foster belonging, strengthen community bonds, and create trusted networks where workers feel supported and less alone.



Suara Kita 6th Anniversary Celebrations


Suara Kita Batik Drawing Workshop


Thingyan Celebrations at Peninsula Plaza


Outing to River Wonders


Outing to Gardens by The Bay


Thanksgiving and HOMEwarming

4. Creative Expression

HOME Family provides platforms for migrant workers to express themselves through art, performance, poetry, and public showcases. These spaces allow them to be recognised as artists, storytellers, and individuals with rich cultural identities.

In 2025, events such as the Batik Show and Parade of National & Cultural Costume Show celebrated cultural heritage, with standout contributions such as Myrna Logiver's Jeepney-inspired outfit. Kaugnay's third Trashion Show, held at the National Gallery Singapore, saw participants transform recycled materials into bold designs under the theme of Superheroes and Villains, reinforcing messages of dignity and resilience. Many participants were supported by employers and neighbours, reflecting strong community involvement.





HOME also partnered with the Singapore Art Museum for the Singapore Biennale, where Filipino artist Eisa Jocson collaborated with HOME Family members on the Karaoke Living Room installation at Lucky Plaza. Writing workshop participants further developed their work into spoken word performances at Aliwal Arts Centre during the She Sails Her Own Sailboat event.

These efforts culminated in International Migrants Day 2025 at UWC Dover, where **more than 400 migrant workers** gathered for performances in music, theatre, and dance alongside advocacy messages. Together, these initiatives build confidence, amplify migrant worker voices, and challenge public perceptions.





In 2025, we had the opportunity to take part in the Home Talent Show. We joined the competition with encouragement from Aunty Khin, who inspired us to represent the Myanmar community. Through this experience, we have grown not only in our dance skills but also in our social connections. Our community has expanded, and performing on the HOME stage truly felt like stepping onto a more advanced level. As we come from different backgrounds, with different languages and cultures, we may not always fully understand each other's words. However, through music and dance, we can still connect and flow together.

Khun Hla Kyaw
Pa-O Youth Cultural Group

Our dance group started with a friend, Pushpa, and I joined because I love dancing. Performing Sri Lankan traditional dance and fusion on stage in Singapore with my team felt amazing. It was a new experience for us, and a very good opportunity for the Sri Lankan community. I really appreciate HOME for giving us this platform and organiser Gina for making it all possible.

Lakmali,
Ekamuthu Kala
Ketha Dance troupe





Batik Show



HOME Talent Show



She Can Sail Her Own Sailboat



International Migrants Day



Kaugnay Collaboration with NUS Tembusu College



Parade of National & Cultural Costume Show



Trashion Show organised by Kaugnay



The Filipino Superwoman X H.O.M.E. Karaoke Living Room (Singapore Biennale 2025)

A Community That Supports

HOME Family fosters a strong culture of giving back, where MDWs actively support one another. HOME Roses' jewellery sales raise funds for the shelter, while HOME Nightingale members visit hospitalised workers to provide comfort and peer support.



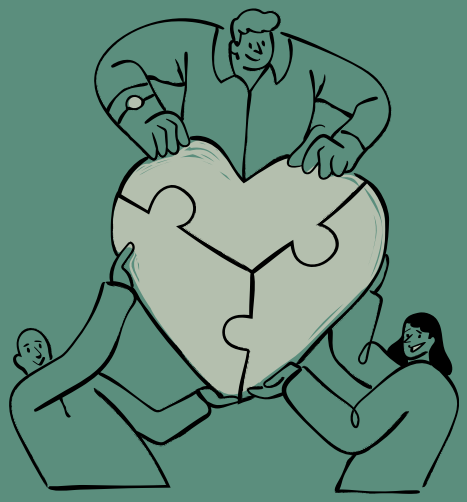
This spirit of mutual aid is most evident in the three Sunday Helpdesks, run by volunteer migrant workers. These peer-led platforms serve as trusted first points of contact, offering advice, emotional support, and referrals to HOME's services. Together, these efforts strengthen networks of trust, solidarity, and care, demonstrating how migrant workers are active agents in building resilient communities.



Advocacy


FAIR TREATMENT
24 HR REST DAY!
MIGRANT WORKER RIGHTS
BAN LORRY RIDES!

Grounded in Casework: Identifying Systemic Issues



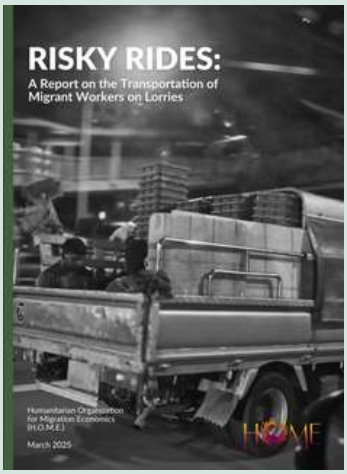
Advocacy at HOME is grounded in the realities we encounter daily through our work with migrant workers. Across our helpdesks, helplines, and shelter, we see recurring patterns — unsafe and exploitative working conditions, persistent wage theft, barriers to healthcare, deceptive recruitment practices, restrictions on workers' autonomy, and, in more serious cases, situations that may amount to forced labour or trafficking.

These experiences shape our advocacy. They are deepened through research, partnerships, community engagement, and ongoing dialogue with stakeholders. We also work closely with other civil society organisations to surface concerns, share knowledge, and amplify issues collectively. Advocacy at HOME is embedded across our work — bringing together casework insights, public engagement, communications, media outreach, and policy advocacy to push for meaningful and lasting change.



Campaigns & Strategic Advocacy

Humans Not Cargo: Ending Lorry Transport



A key advocacy focus in 2025 was the campaign to end the transportation of migrant workers on the back of lorries.

We launched *Risky Rides: A Report on the Transportation of Migrant Workers on Lorries*, calling for a ban on this long-standing but unsafe practice. The report set out the legislative history, an overview of policy developments relating to lorry transport, and insights from migrant workers who had experienced being transported on lorries. It also drew on stakeholder perspectives and set out policy recommendations. The report was launched through both civil society engagement and a public media event.



The public launch brought together members of the media, academics, and civil society organisations, and featured a presentation of the report's findings followed by a panel discussion. The discussion underscored the lived realities of workers and the need for systemic change to prioritise their safety and dignity.

Following the launch, the campaign developed into a multi-platform effort. Initiatives such as the @HumansNotCargo platform and street interviews helped surface public perspectives and sustain attention on the issue.





The issue was subsequently raised in Parliament by various MPs, including Mr Melvin Yong, Mr Ong Hua Han and Ms He Ting Ru, reflecting growing public and policy attention on the safety of migrant workers during their daily commute.

Rest, Health, and Dignity at Work

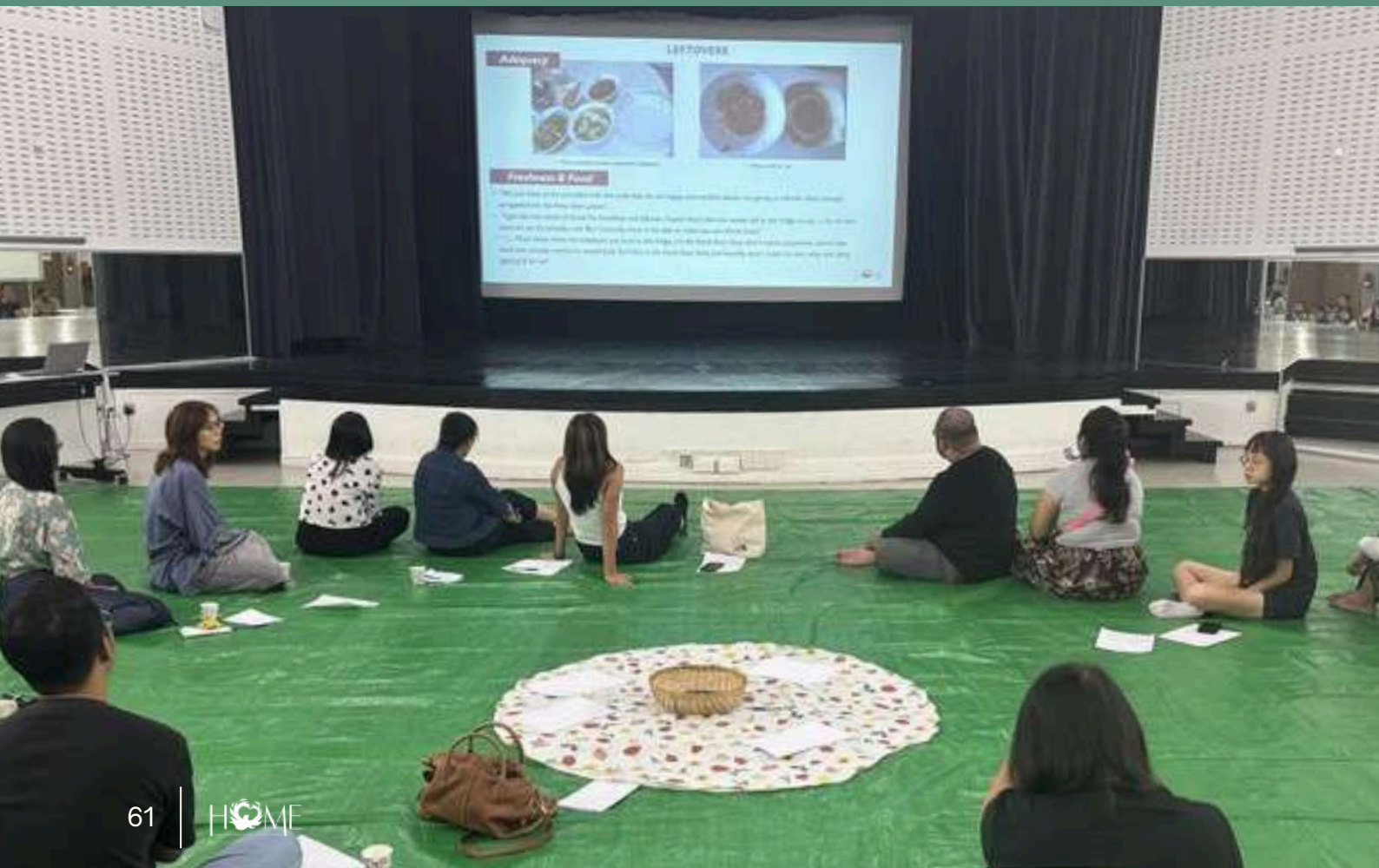


Advocacy efforts also focused on issues affecting migrant domestic workers' daily lives, particularly rest, food insecurity, and access to healthcare.

The #RestDayAllDay campaign reached **over 1,000 physical signatures,** reflecting increasing public recognition of the need for meaningful rest provisions.

We continued to highlight the financial and structural barriers workers face when seeking medical treatment, especially where illness may affect their employment status or lead to repatriation.

We also conducted qualitative research on food insecurity among MDWs, including a focus group discussion and a series of in-depth interviews. Preliminary findings were shared at an event held at the Geylang East Public Library in partnership with SayurStory, creating space for community dialogue on an issue that is often under-recognised.

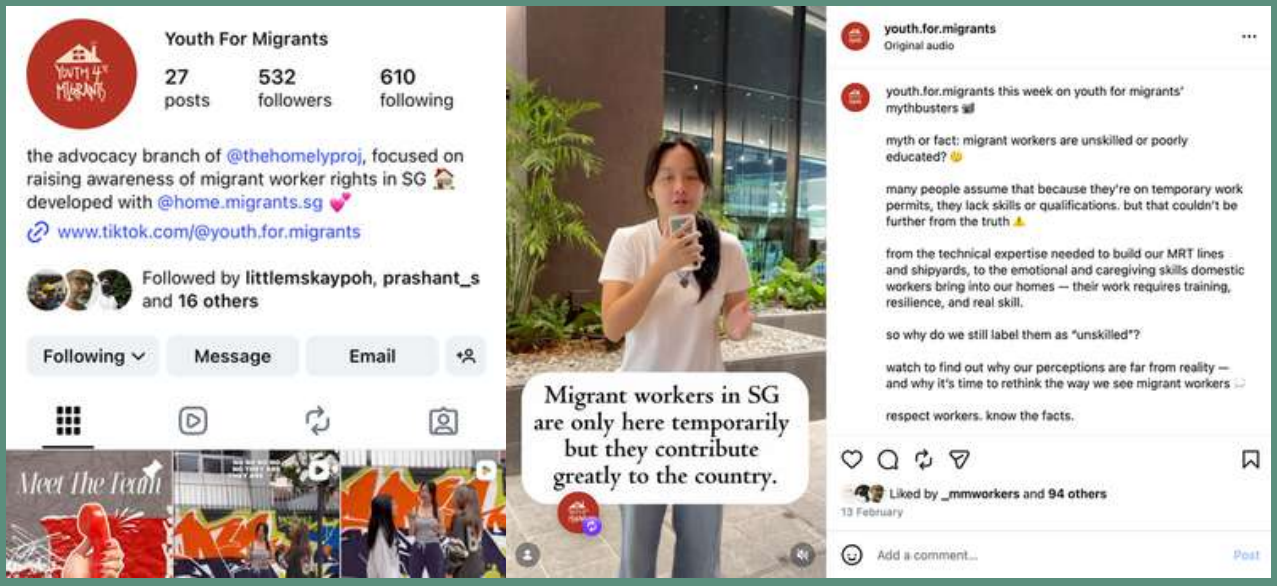


Public Engagement

A key component of our advocacy is shaping public understanding of migrant worker issues across different audiences.



Engagement with students and educational institutions formed an important part of this work. Through talks and dialogues with schools, we sought to foster more informed and empathetic perspectives among younger audiences.



We also nurtured the Youth For Migrants platform, to support the development of content for their social media platform, contributing to peer-led awareness and outreach.

Public Engagement



Our HOME, Our Stories Launch at Book Bar



Yale University Model UN Booth



Talk at Kwong Wai Shu Hospital



Research Sharing Session with Singapore Management University



Human Library at Temasek Polytechnic



Talk at Singapore Chief Residency Programme Seminar

Policy Advocacy & Stakeholder Engagement

Alongside public advocacy, HOME engages directly with policymakers, embassies, and other stakeholders, including local and international NGOs.



Global Compact for Migration (Bangkok)

In 2025, this included a joint submission for the Universal Periodic Review with TWC2, and consultations on upcoming legislative amendments (such as the Employment Act). We also participated in regional and international forums such as the Global Compact for Migration in Bangkok, Thailand, contributing perspectives on migrant worker rights, exploitation, forced labour, and safe migration practices.



ASEAN Forum on Migrant Labour (Kuala Lumpur)



Responsible Business and Migration in ASEAN (Bangkok)

HOME works with Parliamentarians from all political parties, as well as Nominated Members of Parliament, to advocate for the migrant worker cause. In 2025, we submitted 25 potential PQs to various Parliamentarians, with about half of them eventually being filed as PQs for sitting throughout the year.

In 2025, HOME worked with TWC2 to submit a joint civil society report for the Universal Periodic Review, raising key concerns affecting migrant workers in Singapore.

These engagements provide important avenues to raise concerns, propose policy changes, and ensure that workers' experiences are reflected in decision-making processes.

Capacity Building

HOME organised an Introduction to Social Policy Analysis workshop in collaboration with the Social Inclusion Project (SIP) at the Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, bringing together participants from across civil society.



Led by Dr Ng Kok Hoe, who leads SIP (and is current HOME President), the session provided a practical introduction to analysing policy issues and created space for discussion and exchange across organisations. Covering topics such as what social policies are, how to evaluate them, and the drivers of policy change, the workshop provided a practical framework for participants to reflect on their own work. Participants shared that they found the session engaging and thought-provoking, and valued the opportunity to learn from and exchange perspectives with others across civil society engaged in different areas of advocacy. HOME intends to continue organising similar initiatives to support knowledge sharing, capacity building, and collaboration within the broader civil society community.



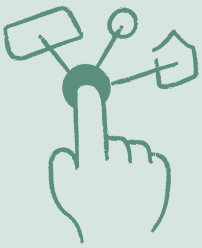
Communications: Social Media Advocacy

In 2025, HOME's social media platforms reached **over 1.4 million views** and generated **more than 28,000 content interactions**, reflecting the growing role of digital platforms in advancing public understanding of migrant worker issues.

1.47 million+
views across social media platforms

28,000+
content interactions

Growing
engagement on TikTok and youth audiences







Across Instagram, Facebook, and TikTok, our content combined storytelling, data-driven explainers, and timely responses to current developments, engaging diverse audiences — from younger viewers on TikTok to established communities on Facebook.

HOME continued to strengthen its digital strategy by translating frontline casework into accessible, public-facing narratives. Short-form video series such as *Kopi Sessions* played a key role in breaking down complex policy issues, while case-based stories helped humanise the lived realities behind them. We also developed a video series reflecting on the case of Indonesian domestic worker Parti Liyani, marking five years since her acquittal and revisiting broader questions around justice and power.



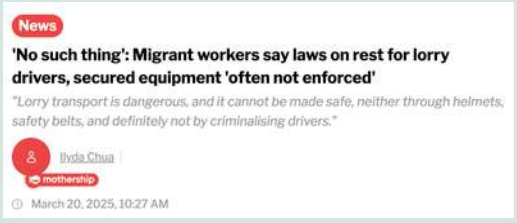




Through collaborations with partners and youth groups, HOME expanded its reach and deepened engagement with new audiences. More than a communications tool, our social media platforms have become an extension of our advocacy — amplifying migrant worker voices, shaping public discourse, and building support for structural change.

Communications: Media and Advocacy

HOME continued to be a trusted voice in the media, with our perspectives sought across mainstream outlets such as *CNA*, *The Straits Times*, and *Business Times*, as well as independent platforms including *Rice Media* and *Mothership*. Our contributions spanned a wide range of issues, from lorry transport safety and healthcare access to food insecurity, rest days, and recruitment practices. This breadth reflects HOME's role as a subject matter expert grounded in frontline casework, with the ability to contextualise policy developments and surface structural concerns.


News

'No such thing': Migrant workers say laws on rest for lorry drivers, secured equipment 'often not enforced'

"Lorry transport is dangerous, and it cannot be made safe, neither through helmets, safety belts, and definitely not by criminalising drivers."

Ilyda Chua

mothership

March 20, 2025, 10:27 AM

Mothership Article


Singapore

'So, so, so tired': The risks and realities of maids caring for babies through the night

Behind the jailing of two domestic helpers for baby abuse lies deeper issues around a labour arrangement one expert referred to as "where the home is a worksite and the worksite is a home".

CNA Article


features | life | C5

These domestic workers share why they volunteer in the lead-up to International Domestic Workers' Day on June 16

Every Sunday, they give back

HOME's MDW volunteers were featured for International Domestic Workers' Day in *The Straits Times*, spotlighting our peer-led model and demonstrating that HOME is not only a crisis-response organisation, but also actively promotes community and capacity building.

HOME also contributed to *The Straits Times* Forum by advocating for the expansion and subsidisation of elder-minding schemes to support families while ensuring migrant domestic workers are afforded adequate rest and basic labour protections.


THE STRAITS TIMES

Log in | Menu

Forum: Encourage and subsidise elder-minding schemes

Sign up now: Get ST's newsletters delivered to your inbox

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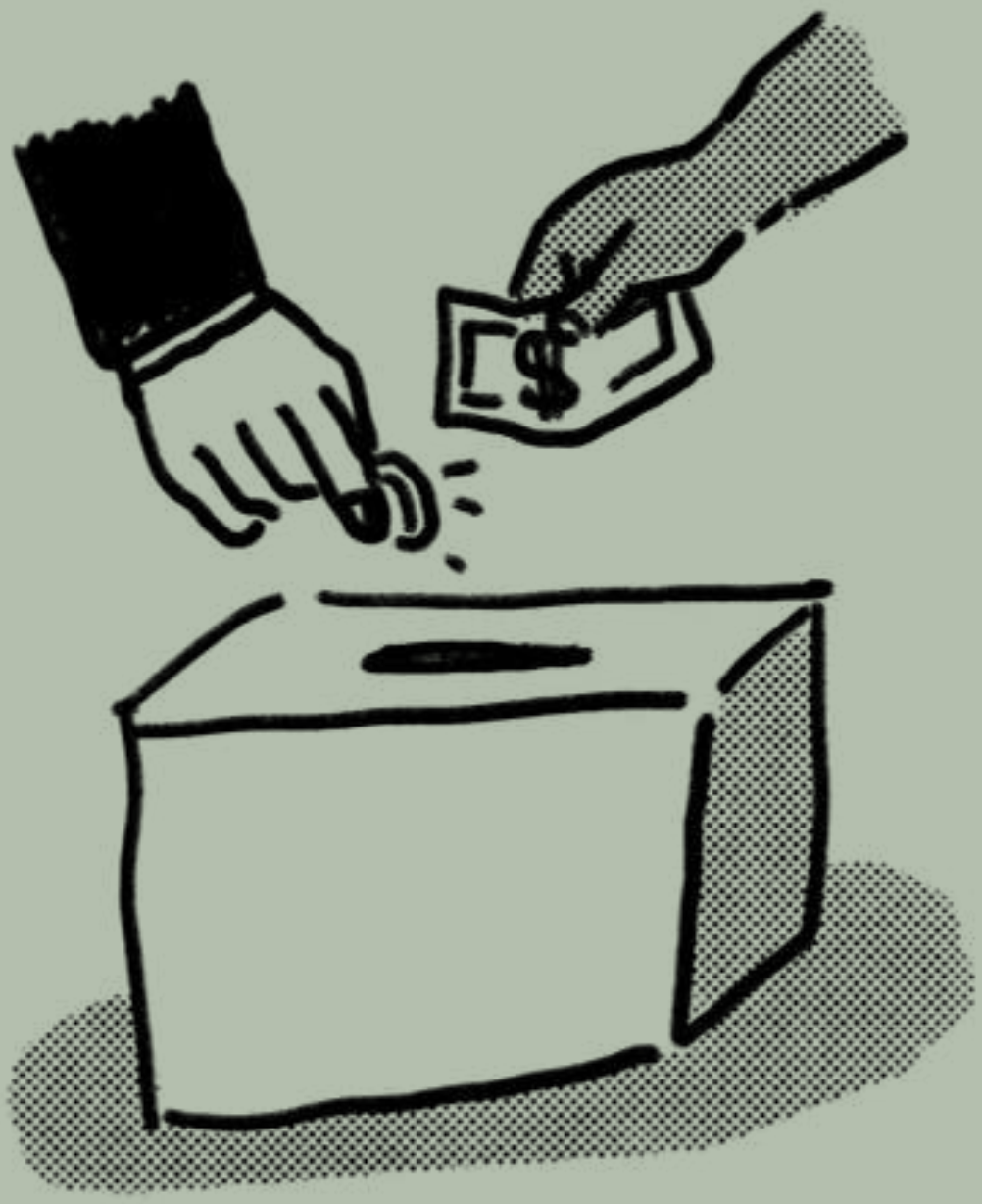
Published Aug 25, 2025, 05:00 AM
Updated Aug 25, 2025, 05:00 AM

We refer to the article "More families in Singapore using childminding and elder-minding services" (Aug 15).

Straits Times Forum Letter

Through these engagements, HOME helped shape public discourse and deepen understanding of the realities faced by migrant workers in Singapore.

Fundraising and Donor Support



Fundraising and Donor Support

HOME relies on a combination of institutional funding, community partnerships, and public donations to sustain our work supporting migrant workers in crisis. In 2025, we continued to receive vital unrestricted support from long-standing institutional partners including the Chen Su Lan Trust and Lee Foundation, while the Asia Pacific Breweries Foundation and the Kwan Im Thong Hood Cho Temple continued programmatic funding for our Shelter and Migrant Worker Helpdesk. We were also grateful to receive a new unrestricted grant from the L87 Foundation, alongside additional support from the Robert H. N. Ho Global Family Foundation for our Shelter.

Beyond institutional giving, HOME continued to be supported by a strong network of community partners and grassroots fundraising efforts. The Australian International School Parents Association organised a pre-loved uniform sale in support of HOME, while groups such as the Italian Women's Group, Indian Women's Association, and Netherlands Charity Association organised community fundraising initiatives for our operational needs. These partnerships reflect a growing community of supporters who believe in the importance of protecting and empowering migrant workers in Singapore.



Beyond monetary contributions, HOME also benefits from generous in-kind support that helps meet the everyday needs of the migrant workers we serve. Our shelter regularly receives fresh produce from food rescue groups and rice from religious organisations, ensuring residents have access to proper nutrition. Starhub also donated laptops to the shelter for volunteers to conduct digital classes on a weekly basis.

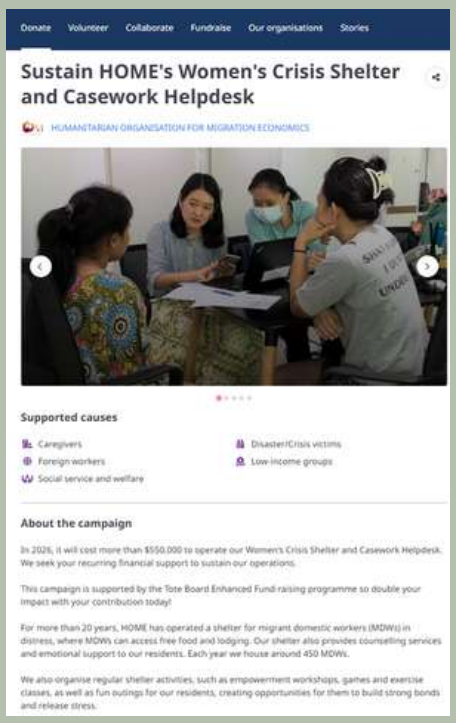
Schools, from kindergartens to tertiary institutions, as well as community groups, also organise donation drives throughout the year, contributing canned food, beverages, toiletries, and other essential items.

These contributions play an important role in sustaining daily care, reducing operating costs, and reminding our beneficiaries that they are supported by a wider community.



HOME Academy was also awarded The Majurity Trust's Scaffold Fund to strengthen the curriculum and content development of our Caregiving, Nursing Aide, and Healthcare courses. Originally developed organically by migrant domestic workers to meet community needs, these peer-led programmes will now be further strengthened through the involvement of healthcare professionals and improved training resources. This investment supports MDWs in providing better care within households while opening pathways towards future employment opportunities in the healthcare sector.

In 2025, HOME also launched an online fundraising campaign in support of our shelter, which qualified for the Tote Board Enhanced Fundraising Programme. The campaign raised more than S$290,000, including a significant contribution from the estate of Mdm Willie Siow Fung Wai Ying, a lifelong philanthropist. Mdm Siow's connection to HOME was deeply personal. Her first caregiver had previously been a resident of HOME's shelter after experiencing abuse under an employer. While receiving care from MDWs in her later years, Mdm Siow remained deeply concerned about their wellbeing and believed strongly in supporting better opportunities and protections for them.



HOME also organised two public-facing fundraising initiatives that combined fundraising with public engagement. At Boutiques Fair Singapore, HOME hosted a sponsored booth selling festive buntings sewn by shelter residents and handcrafted earrings by board member Gusti Seruni. Beyond raising funds, the fair created opportunities to engage the public in conversations about the lived experiences of migrant workers.





On International Migrants Day, board members Ryan Chua and Grace Baey collaborated with photographer Juliana Tan, video editor Denise Oliveiro, and eleven of our beneficiaries to present the *More To Us* fundraising exhibition at Objectifs. The exhibition featured portraits and personal reflections of the MDWs who volunteer with HOME, alongside video works and winning pieces from the 2025 Trashion Show. The event created meaningful opportunities for donors and members of the public to engage directly with migrant workers and gain deeper insight into their experiences, talents, and contributions.



Through these collective efforts, **HOME raised more than S$2 million in 2025 and recorded a surplus of approximately S$254,861**, reversing the deficit recorded in the preceding three years. These contributions enabled HOME to sustain and strengthen our welfare, empowerment, and advocacy work for migrant workers across Singapore.

Volunteers



Volunteers: Strengthening a Community of Support



Volunteers at the Heart of HOME's Work

HOME is a lean organisation with only 11 full-time staff, and volunteers are central to the delivery of our services across all fronts. From shelter support and casework assistance to translation, legal support, and community outreach, volunteers extend our capacity and deepen the reach of our work. MDWs also volunteer to take the lead in organising HOME Family events and teach at HOME Academy. In 2025, **170 volunteers contributed more than 9092 hours** to support our services. Their contributions enable HOME to respond to a wide range of needs while sustaining the spirit of solidarity that underpins our mission.

Volunteer Capability Development

In 2025, HOME strengthened our volunteer management processes to better support both new and existing volunteers. We developed a structured onboarding process, including orientation sessions, volunteer agreements, and role-specific training where needed. Volunteering opportunities were also consolidated online, making it easier for potential volunteers to understand available roles, expectations, and requirements.

Volunteer Engagement

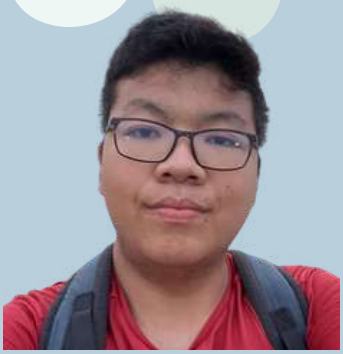
To strengthen communication and connection, HOME launched a WhatsApp Community chat for volunteers, with weekly updates under the title "What's up HOMiEs!". This channel keeps volunteers informed about HOME's latest social media posts, upcoming events, and opportunities to get involved. It also helps foster a stronger sense of belonging among volunteers who may otherwise only interact within their specific shifts or departments.

Growing the Volunteer Pipeline

Volunteer engagement in 2025 also extended to outreach and recruitment. Staff and volunteers participated in SMU's SOSCIETY Charity Walk, where HOME hosted a booth alongside other charities to raise awareness about migrant worker issues and connect with potential student volunteers. HOME also continued to identify priority volunteer needs, particularly legally trained volunteers and translators to support increasingly complex casework.

Recognition and Sustaining Volunteerism

In October, we held a volunteer appreciation event for shelter, casework, communications, research, and Youth for Migrants volunteers. The event created space for volunteers across different teams to meet one another, reflect on their experiences, and share what keeps them committed to this work. These moments of recognition and connection are vital in nurturing a sustainable culture of volunteerism, one rooted not only in service, but in community, care, and shared purpose.



You Xuanxiang, MDW Helpdesk Casework Volunteer

I first came to HOME through a school internship, but returned as a volunteer because I realised HOME is more than an organisation. It is a community that listens when migrant domestic workers feel unheard.

Working with the casework team taught me to approach each case with empathy and without bias. What stayed with me most were interviews where workers broke down while speaking about their fear of their employers, even when they were clearly being mistreated.

These experiences changed how I see migrant domestic workers in Singapore. Behind every worker is a person with family, struggles, and hopes. Recognising their humanity is the first step to treating them with dignity and respect.

We started Youth For Migrants because we had seen, up close, some of the unfair treatment migrant domestic workers face, and we wanted to do more than just be aware. Through HOME, we create social media content to help other young people understand these issues, and we conduct computer lessons at the shelter to support residents in practical ways. Interacting with the women has been very meaningful. Seeing them laugh, open up, and enjoy learning reminds us that migrant workers are not just part of Singapore's economy, but people with dignity, stories, and talents. We hope more youths will recognise this and play their part in building a more empathetic and fair community.



Student leaders, Youth For Migrants



Ritu Malhotra, Migrant Worker Helpdesk Casework Volunteer

I was drawn to volunteer with HOME's Migrant Worker Helpdesk because it supports migrant workers facing difficult and often invisible struggles. Many leave behind their families, countries, and support systems to provide better lives for their loved ones. While helping with salary matters, workplace injuries, employment disputes, or unfamiliar procedures is important, the human connection matters just as much. Being able to communicate in a familiar language can bring comfort to someone who feels isolated, and reminds me how empathy helps people feel seen and supported.

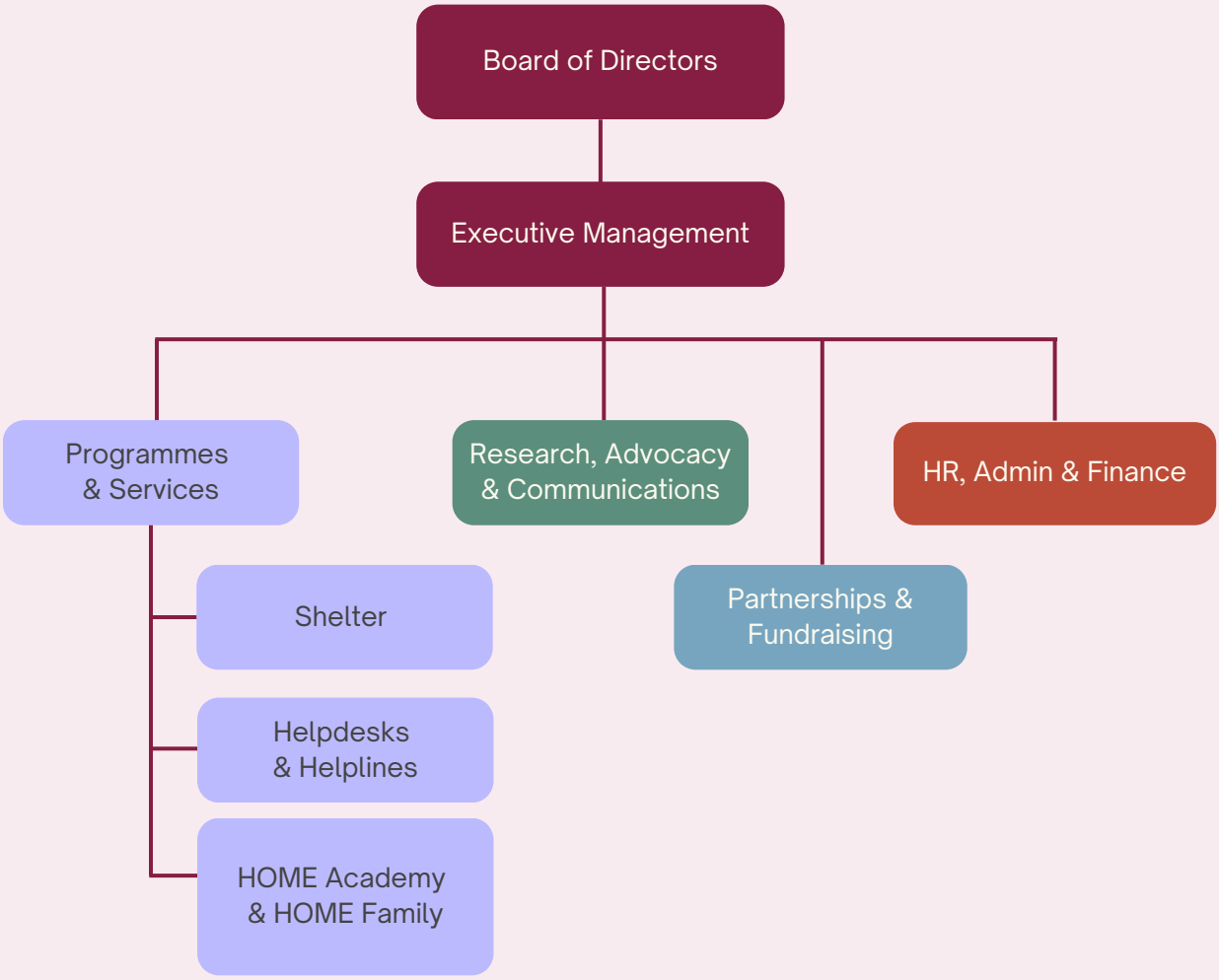
I have been inspired by the resilience and dignity of the workers I meet. Volunteering at HOME has strengthened my belief in empathy, inclusion, and our responsibility to one another.

Governance



Staff Organisational Structure

HOME continues to operate with a lean team of passionate staff. Staff strength was 11 as of 31 December 2025, as distributed below:



Executive Management

Executive Director: Stephanie Chok
Appointed September 2023

Deputy Director: Prashant Somosundram
Appointed July 2025

Remuneration

No staff are involved in setting their own remuneration. No paid staff are close family members of the Executive Management or Board Members. During FY 2025, there was one staff whose annual remuneration was within the band of $100,000 and $120,000; there is no staff whose annual remuneration exceeds $120,000.

HOME's Board 2025

HOME is guided by a committed Board of Directors who provide strategic oversight, uphold strong stewardship practices, and ensure accountability in the organisation's work. Drawing on diverse professional backgrounds — including law, research, communications, social services, business, and community development — Board members bring a breadth of perspectives that supports informed decision-making and long-term planning.

Working closely with management, the Board plays a key role in guiding HOME's overall direction, strengthening organisational systems, and ensuring the long-term sustainability of our programmes and advocacy efforts. They also play an important role in ensuring that the organisation remains anchored in its values and mission, particularly as HOME navigates a complex and evolving operating environment.

Beyond governance, Board members contribute in a range of ways that strengthen HOME's work. This includes supporting external engagement and relationship-building, providing strategic counsel in sensitive contexts, and helping to mobilise resources and networks to sustain and grow our programmes. Their continued commitment reinforces HOME's ability to serve migrant workers with integrity, care, and purpose.

Election and Term Limits

In accordance with HOME's Constitution, Board members are elected every two years at the Annual General Meeting (AGM). The most recent election was held on 2 June 2024.

The Treasurer may serve a maximum of four consecutive years (two terms), in line with governance guidelines. The revised Code of Governance for Charities (2023) further recommends a maximum term limit of 10 years for all Board members. HOME remains in compliance with these recommendations, with no current Board member having served beyond this limit.



Board Members

Term: 2024-2026
Read more about our board members here



Dr Ng Kok Hoe
President



S Suraendher Kumarr
Vice-President



Leon Anil Perera
Treasurer



Ryan Chua
Vice-Treasurer



Tan Heng Yeng
Secretary



Grace Baey
Vice-Secretary



David Puvan
Member



Gerard Ee
Member



Gusti Seruni
Member



Priscilla Chia
Member

Subcommittees

SUBCOMMITTEE	MEMBERS
Finance	Leon Anil Perera (Chair) David Puvaneyshwaran Chua Yong Sheng
HR & Admin	Tan Heng Yeng (Chair) Priscilla Chia
Research & Advocacy	Ng Kok Hoe (Chair) Grace Baey Hui Yi Suraendher S Kumarr Leon Anil Perera
Fundraising	David Puvaneyshwaran (Chair) Tan Heng Yeng
Programmes & Services	Gusti Seruni Soeprijatno (Chair) Chua Yong Sheng
Audit	Gerard Ee (Chair) John Foulley (Volunteer)
Communications	Grace Baey Hui Yi (Chair) Gusti Seruni Soeprijatno

Attendance

NAME & POSITION ON THE BOARD	OCCUPATION	PREVIOUS POSITION AS BOARD MEMBER	DATE OF APPOINTMENT	NO. OF MEETINGS ATTENDED (2025)
Ng Kok Hoe *PRESIDENT*	Senior Research Fellow	NA	2 June 2024	4/4
S Suraendher Kumarr *VICE-PRESIDENT*	Community Worker	Secretary (2022-2024)	23 Aug 2020	4/4
Leon Anil Perera *TREASURER*	Executive Director	Board Member (2009-2013)	2 June 2024	4/4
Chua Yong Sheng *VICE-TREASURER*	Outreach Director	NA	2 June 2024	4/4
Tan Heng Yeng *SECRETARY*	HR Chief Administrative Officer	NA	2 June 2024	4/4
Grace Baey Hui Yi *VICE-SECRETARY*	Photographer & Filmmaker	NA	2 June 2024	4/4
David Puvaneyshwaran *MEMBER*	Graduate Student	NA	2 June 2024	4/4
Gerard Ee Huck Lian *MEMBER*	Director, Non-profit Organisation	NA	2 June 2024	4/4
Gusti Seruni Soeprijatno *MEMBER*	Business Owner	NA	2 June 2024	4/4
Priscilla Chia Wen Qi *MEMBER*	Lawyer	NA	2 June 2024	4/4

Board Meetings and Attendance

The Board meets regularly throughout the year to review organisational performance, provide oversight on key developments, and guide HOME's direction and priorities. In FY2025, a total of 4 Board meetings (outside of subcommittee meetings) and 1 Annual General Meeting were held.

The Board also convened a strategic workshop to reflect on organisational priorities and longer-term direction. At year's end, the Board also held a joint session with staff, creating space for staff to share their year-end achievements and aspirations for the year ahead, and to strengthen alignment across the organisation.

Board members actively contribute their expertise through both full Board discussions and subcommittee work, supporting informed decision-making and effective oversight.

Governance

HOME is committed to upholding strong standards of accountability, transparency, and ethical practice. The Board provides oversight of the organisation's governance framework, including policies and processes relating to risk management, financial stewardship, and regulatory compliance.

The Board also reviews organisational performance, approves key policies and budgets, and ensures that HOME's work remains aligned with its mission, values, and charitable objectives.

Remuneration

All Board and Board Committee members serve on a voluntary basis and contribute their time and expertise pro bono. They do not receive any allowance, honorarium, or remuneration for their services.

Related Entities

HOME does not have any related entities. There are no Board members who are close family members of the Executive Director or any staff member.

Management of Conflict of Interest

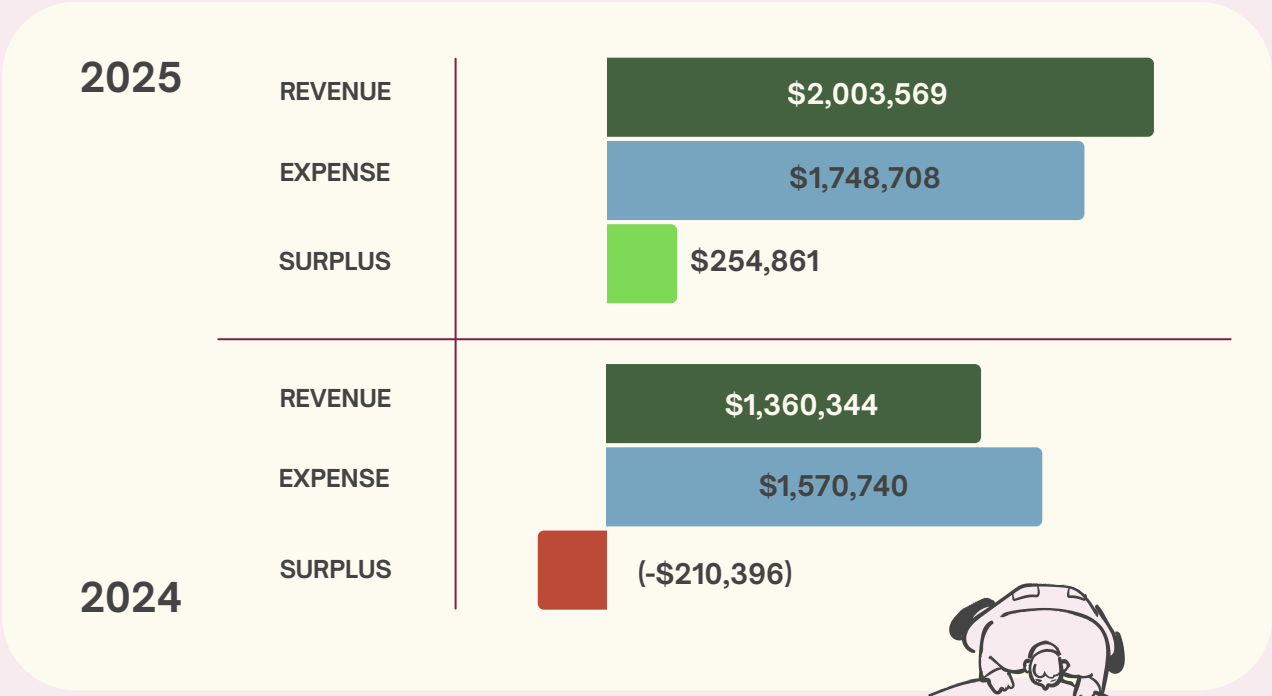
HOME has a documented conflict-of-interest policy to safeguard the integrity of its governance and decision-making processes. All Board members are required to review and acknowledge the policy, declare any actual or potential conflicts of interest, and complete a declaration form.

Where a conflict arises, the individual concerned will disclose the nature of the interest and recuse themselves from the relevant discussions, decision-making, and voting.

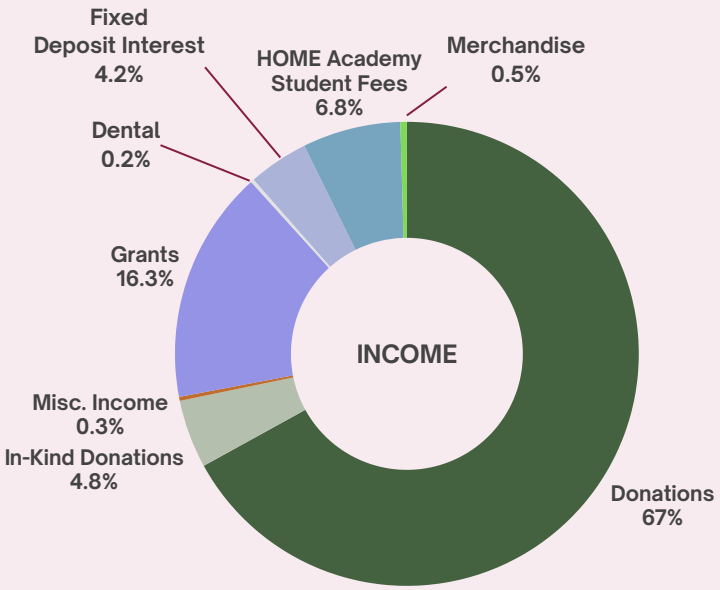
Financial Overview

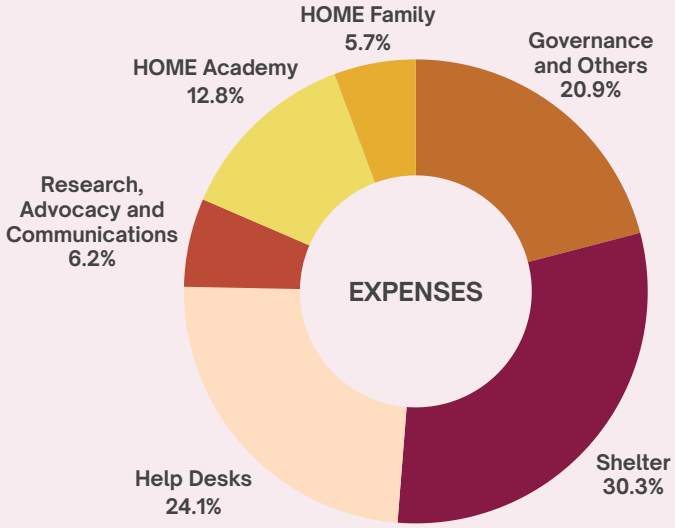
The financial statements of HOME are drawn up in accordance with the provisions of the Societies Act 1966, the Charities Act 1994 and other relevant regulations and Charities Accounting Standard in Singapore.

For information on HOME's major financial transactions please refer to the 2025 Audited Financial Statements found **here**.









HOME maintains its reserve policy at a level which is at least equivalent to three to four years of the current operating expenses. These reserves are currently held in either current or fixed deposit accounts.

	2025	2024
Total Unrestricted Funds	6,709,755	6,454,894
Annual Operating Expenses	1,748,708	1,570,740
Reserve Ratio	3.84	4.11

Organisational Policies

Constitutional Revision

In 2024, HOME undertook a review of its Constitution — the Society's governing instrument — to ensure alignment with evolving operational needs, governance expectations, and regulatory standards. Overseen by a temporary Constitution Review Subcommittee led by a Board member with legal training, the review included updates to provisions relating to Board composition and appointment, membership categories, financial processes, and dissolution procedures, among others. The revised Constitution was finalised and approved by the Registrar of Societies in July 2025.

Other Policies

HOME continued to strengthen and review key organisational policies and internal systems in 2025 to support good governance, accountability, staff and volunteer safeguarding, and operational effectiveness.

HOME continues to uphold and implement the following core policies:

- Employee Handbook
- Whistleblowing Policy
- Finance Manual
- Board and Staff Code of Conduct
- Volunteer Code of Conduct and Agreements
- Internship Guidelines and Agreements
- Anti-Money Laundering and Countering Terrorism Financing Policy
- Communications Guidelines
- Data Management Plan



Looking Ahead



Priorities for 2026 & Beyond

Guided, as always, by the workers we serve, HOME enters 2026 with a clearer sense of both the urgency and complexity of the work ahead. The challenges facing migrant workers in Singapore are not easing — they are evolving, and in many cases becoming more difficult to navigate. Our response must continue to evolve alongside them.

1 Deepening Welfare and Protection

The issues surfacing at our helpdesks and shelter point to a changing landscape of harm. Deceptive recruitment and job misrepresentation have become more prevalent, leaving workers — particularly those from Myanmar — in highly precarious situations. We will continue to strengthen our casework response and welfare support, and work to ensure that workers who have been deceived or placed in irregular situations have access to meaningful protection and redress.





2 Sustaining and Growing Community

HOME Family and HOME Academy remain central to our mission. We will continue investing in peer-led programming that places migrant workers at the helm of our work — supporting our Sunday Helpdesks, community groups, and volunteer trainers, ensuring they have the resources, wellbeing support, and recognition they deserve. We also hope to grow participation across both programmes, deepening our reach among migrant workers of different nationalities and ensuring our community remains as diverse and inclusive as the people we serve.

For HOME Academy, we will build on our TESDA certification programmes and industry partnerships to expand livelihood pathways (e.g. into healthcare), while keeping learning accessible and flexible for workers with limited rest days.

Priorities for 2026 & Beyond

3 Advancing Advocacy

Our advocacy pipeline for 2026 is anchored in the work we began in 2025 and shaped by what we are seeing at our frontlines. The rise in deceptive recruitment — workers arriving to find their jobs, salaries, or conditions bear little resemblance to what they were promised — is one of the most troubling trends we have encountered in recent years. HOME will deepen its research and advocacy on this issue, documenting patterns and identifying gaps in existing protections.

We will continue pushing for a complete ban on lorry transport for migrant workers — the partial ban on caged lorries falls far short of what is needed — and press on with the #RestDayAllDay campaign and our research on food insecurity. We will also advocate for stronger safeguards for workers who come forward to report exploitation, so that the fear of debarment or penalisation does not silence those who have already been wronged.

Public engagement remains a vital part of our advocacy. We will continue working with academic institutions and student groups to build awareness and empathy around migrant worker issues, and maintain regular media engagement — through features and timely responses to policy developments — to keep these issues visible and ensure that workers' experiences inform public discourse. More broadly, we will sustain our engagement with policymakers, parliamentarians, embassies, and regional and international forums.



Priorities for 2026 & Beyond

4 Nurturing Partnerships and Collaboration

The breadth of HOME's work in 2025 would not have been possible without the generosity and commitment of our many partners. From law firms providing pro bono representation to corporations supporting our shelter and community through CSR and fundraising; from practitioners — doctors, therapists, educators, and artists — sharing their expertise through classes and workshops, to cultural institutions opening new spaces for migrant workers to be seen and celebrated — each of these partnerships has enriched our work in ways that go far beyond what HOME could achieve alone. In 2026, we look forward to sustaining and growing these collaborations, and to welcoming new partners who share our belief that every migrant worker deserves to live and work with dignity.





5 Building Organisational Resilience

None of this work is possible without a stable and supported organisation. We will continue to invest in our staff and volunteers — through structured training, capacity building, and wellbeing support. The joint Board-staff session held in 2025 has strengthened alignment across the organisation, and we will carry that spirit of shared purpose into the year ahead. Financially, we will pursue a diversified strategy combining major donor relationships, project grants, and community fundraising, while maintaining the prudent stewardship that our mission demands.

HOME's work is sustained by many: the staff who show up every day, the volunteers who give their time and skills, the donors and partners who believe in our mission, and above all, the migrant workers who place their trust in us. As the landscape shifts, we will continue to move with it — grounded, responsive, and committed to the long work ahead.



Thank you for standing with migrant workers in 2025.

Humanitarian Organization for Migration Economics
UEN: T04SS0193H
720 Geylang Road #02-01, Singapore 389631
contact@home.org.sg
home.org.sg

: *home.migrants.sg*